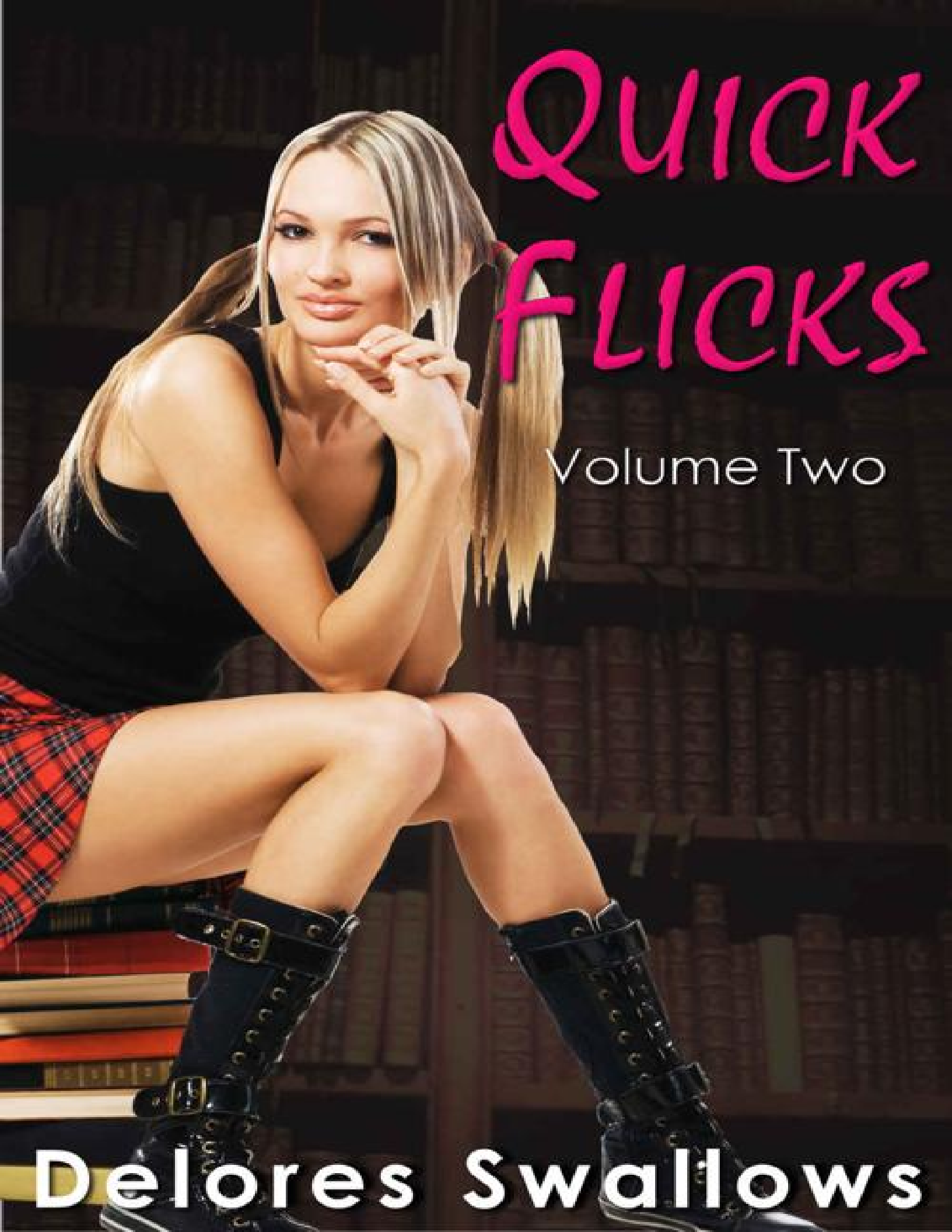




QUICK FLICKS

Volume Two

Delores Swallows

Quick Flicks Volume Two

A Collection of Short Stories

by Delores Swallows

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Content Advisory: This book is intended for mature audiences and contains explicit sexual activity.

Quick Flicks (Volume Two)

A collection of five short stories about men getting hot and heavy with strangers, girlfriends and wives—and even with other men's wives.

College jock Tyler thinks he's hit paydirt when he manages to take gorgeous MILF Kim back to his place, only to realise he's nothing more than another notch on her heavily marked bedpost.

A light-hearted conversation between old friends Aiden and Ollie reveals that one of them is deceiving his girlfriend in order to get hotter sex...but she has a little deception of her own.

When Michael is let out of his cage, he certainly makes the most of his opportunity with young and beautiful Tanya.

Scott fulfils the dream of a lifetime by visiting Africa, where he experiences not only the wildlife, but also the wilder side of life.

When the stress of a demanding job and a demanding wife get too much for George, an old ally somehow manages to help him find his way through the pitfalls, despite seemingly trying to point him in all the wrong directions.

Read what's goings-on and who's getting-off as the action flips from the USA to the UK, and from Africa to Cloud Cuckoo Land.

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$$\Psi$$


Slut

“So,” Tyler said, struggling to keep his eyes on her face rather than her killer body, “can I tempt you with another drink?”

Kim gave him a sexy smile and reached over to stroke his bulging bicep. “You could tempt me with a lot of things.”

He laughed, his cock swelling inside his boxers. “Now that makes me wish I’d offered you more than another drink.”

“I worked in finance for twenty years, so I’m used to negotiating people up from their first offer.”

For the first time since he was about fourteen, Tyler was out of his depth. He’d always been able to charm girls, and his looks made it easy to get into their panties. Kim was different. “So what sort of thing should I be tempting you with?”

Another sexy smile creased her face. “Well, I can get myself a drink. But you have something I can’t get myself...” She traced a polished fingernail down his forearm, making the hairs on the back of his neck stand up.

He swallowed. “I’m pretty sure you could get just about whatever you want.”

“Oh honey, I do.” She gave a confident laugh. “Believe me, I *always* get what I want.”

His cock was now straining against his jeans. “And what is it you want tonight?”

She ran her tongue over her scarlet-glossed lips, leaned close and whispered, “I want a fit young man to spend a couple of hours between my legs.”

Paydirt! “I’ll be happy to do that.”

“I know you will.” Kim slipped off her stool, straightened her short dress and took his hand. “I’ll make you happier than you’ve ever been.”

Tyler walked her out of the bar, hoping his college buddies saw him leave with the best-looking MILF in the city. The short dress and four-inch heels emphasised her perfect legs.

He decided he ought to try making small talk on the way. “I’m guessing you’re not from Washington.”

“I’m not from anywhere in the States. I’m English.”

This surprised him. “Sorry, I thought you sounded—”

“I’ve lived in New York for seven years. I married an American.”

His face must have shown his shock because she laughed and squeezed his hand tighter. “Don’t worry, I’m not married to him now.”

“Ah, right.” He smiled, then refocussed on pretending to be interested. “So whereabouts in Eng—?”

“It doesn’t matter.” She stopped on the sidewalk and pulled him close, pressing her body against his. Tyler was six-two, and her heels made it so she was only a couple of inches shorter than him. “What matters is that I’m in DC and you’re the only man I know. You have a great body and a hard-on. Let’s not lose sight of what’s important by talking about things neither of us care about.”

He swallowed. “And what’s important?”

She reached down and gripped his cock through his jeans. “Getting this inside me.”

A nervous shiver ran down his back. He looked up the street to see if anyone had seen her groping his pecker. “Do you have a hotel room?”

She shook her head. “I want to see your room. Does it have pennants on the wall like in the movies?”

He laughed and led her through the streets back to the apartment he shared. Andy had gone to a concert and would probably go drinking afterwards. He wouldn’t be home for hours.

Once they were a block away, he looked at her. “So I’m not allowed to do small talk at all?”

“I prefer pillow talk.” She stroked her long, blonde-streaked hair behind one ear. “We can do that afterwards, while you’re getting your breath back.”

This chick is unreal.

Tyler was relieved that the apartment looked fairly tidy, but Kim didn't seem to notice. Her eyes went straight to the three internal doors.

"Which one's your bedroom?" she asked.

He pointed to the one on the left, praying he hadn't left any dirty boxers on the floor. Kim strode inside, and he followed, closing the door behind him.

"Strip," she commanded.

"Excuse me?"

"Get your kit off and lie on the bed."

He chuckled and pulled his white tee up over his head, happy to see her gaze run over his abs and shoulders. He spent three hours a day working out to get reactions like that. Next he kicked off his hi-tops and pushed down his jeans, then stood up straight and looked at her.

"And your shorts."

He smiled confidently. "I was hoping you could help me with those while I unzip that dress of yours."

She pulled her dress downwards. It was made from some stretchy material, and the neckline just spread and slipped over her shoulders without resistance. As she continued to pull, two perfect breasts popped free. Then a narrow waist and flat stomach were revealed, and finally the swell of her hips and a completely shaved pussy. She'd gone to a downtown bar wearing a very short dress and no underwear.

She stepped out of the dress but left her red shoes on. She looked like a goddess and Tyler worried he might come in his pants.

"Stop drooling, take your shorts off and lie on the bed."

He did as he was told, wondering whether he should get the condoms from his drawer first.

Kim climbed onto the bed and gripped his cock. She ran her thumb over the tip, massaging in the precum. "I like your cock."

"Thanks." Some girls struggled to take it all, but he doubted Kim would have any problem.

She leaned down and licked off the precum, then looked into his eyes. “Do you think you have an STD?”

He frowned and shook his head, surprised and offended by the question. “No, of course not.”

“Good. Me neither and I really want to feel this beauty bare.”

Before he had the chance to answer, she moved up the bed and lowered herself onto his erection. He let out a yelp of surprise, then a long sigh as she clenched and started to move her hips in small circles. He dropped his head back and revelled in the sensations.

Kim kept her eyes on his face, the hint of a smile curling up the corners of her mouth. “Do you think you’ll be able to keep your jizz in your balls long enough for a lady to have an orgasm?”

He smirked. “I’m not sure that a *lady* would do this on her first date.”

She laughed. “She would if she was a slutty lady.”

“Is that how you describe yourself?”

Kim scrunched her nose. “A slut, yes. A lady, not so much.” She started to grind down on his pubic bone. “But as I’ve already told you, we can talk while you recuperate.”

“Yes, ma’am.”

“And don’t ignore my tits. They cost my husband a fortune.”

Tyler reached up and caressed the firm spheres, tracing his thumbs over her dark pink nipples. Her body was as good as any of the undergrads he’d ever bedded, and she certainly used it better than all of them.

“Mmm.” Her breathing became a little ragged, and she smiled down at him. “Well, that’s me at the top of the ski slope.”

“Huh?”

She leaned down to look into his face. “I’m at that delicious point of no return, so you can come whenever you’re ready.”

Tyler stared at her in amazement. Kim sat upright, closed her eyes and bounced harder. She let out a low groan and her pussy closed around him like a vice. He cried out and exploded inside her.

“Yeah, that’s it.” She wriggled and swayed, snaking her hand behind her and massaging his balls. “Give me all of that lovely cum.”

He was too engrossed in the way her pussy was rippling around his dick to respond. His fists were almost shredding the bedcover.

“I want every... last... fucking...” She brought her own hands up and tugged at her nipples. “Drop.”

He clenched his teeth and arched upward, lifting her with him.

Kim jerked her hips forward and back. She reached down and squeezed his nipples, then he felt her clenching again. She let out a little sigh then opened her eyes and smiled. “Mmm, second helpings already. Good boy.”

Tyler was exhausted even though she’d done all the work. Kim slipped off him and, to his amazement, took his shrinking cock into her mouth and licked it clean.

She looked up and smiled at him, then crawled up the bed and kissed his lips, pushing her tongue into his mouth.

Tyler opened his eyes wide but didn’t resist. He’d kissed girls who’d blown him before. Moving his tongue against hers, he let his hands get reacquainted with her tits. He slid his hands downwards, enjoying the smoothness of her hips and the firmness of her backside. Maybe she’d had other parts of her body worked on as well.

“So,” he said, wrapping one of his arms around her, “is this where we have pillow talk?”

She smiled, snuggled up next to him and rested her arm over his waist. “If you like.”

“Tell me what it was like growing up in England.”

She seemed surprised by his question, then shrugged. “It was fine. I went to a good school and got good grades. Over there, the age of consent for sex is sixteen, so I got educated in a lot more than just the three R’s.”

He smiled. “Tell me about it, and I don’t mean the reading, writing or ’rithmetic.”

She took a breath. “The first time a boy told me I was pretty, I kissed him. When he told me he liked my kisses, I let him play with my

tits.”

Tyler chuckled.

“When his friend told me that he thought I was pretty, I let him play with my tits as well.”

“You were a heartbreaker?”

She laughed. “Apparently. When one of the older boys told me I was sexy, I let him put his hand down my knickers. It was the first time anyone had touched me there, and I came as soon as his finger went inside. I came again as he finger-fucked me against the wall of the school. Then I touched his cock, and he made a mess on my uniform.”

“Jeez.”

“When another boy called me a cock-tease, I sucked him off.”

“You *what*?”

“I was walking through the playground when I heard someone say, ‘Kimberley Cock-Tease.’”

“Your name’s Kimberley?”

She nodded. “I turned and saw Josh Denning, a pimply boy from my own class. I asked why he’d called me that, and he said it was because of the way I walked, the way I wore my uniform and the way I rubbed my legs together when talking to boys from the rugby team.”

“Did you tell him to fuck off?”

“No. I pointed out that I walked and wore my uniform the same way all the other girls did. Then I told him talking to the boys from the rugby team made me wet, and that by rubbing my legs together I could make myself come without them knowing.”

Tyler shook his head in disbelief. “Jesus, Kim.”

“Then I led him to a gap between the changing rooms, dropped to my knees and pulled his cock out.”

“What did he say?”

“Nothing. He stood there shaking like the big kid he was. I slipped it into my mouth and bobbed my head. He yelped and came in less than ten seconds. I swallowed, stood up and told him I didn’t tease. Then I walked off and left him with his dick hanging out.”

Tyler was almost speechless. "Had you sucked guys off before?"

"Nope. That was my first time, but he never knew that."

"So when did you lose your cherry?"

"Not long afterwards. I let the first boy who told me he loved me take my virginity. I loved the feeling of being loved, and before long I'd been loved by another eight boys in his class."

"Eight?"

She shrugged. "Like I said, I'm a slut. Pretty soon nobody fucking loved me, but everybody loved fucking me, and I realised I was happy with that."

"I wish I'd known you at school."

She laughed. "When I was at school you weren't even a twinkle in your daddy's eye. How old are you...?" She frowned.

"You've forgotten my name."

She laughed and nodded. "Sorry. When you mentioned it in the bar, I was already imagining you naked."

"It's Tyler."

"Tyler, that's right. I remember now."

"No you don't."

She smiled. "You never answered my question."

"I'm twenty-one."

"Ah, perfect. In three years' time I'll be twice your age."

He frowned as he tried to work out how old that made her.

"I'm assuming you're not majoring in arithmetic. When you're twenty-four, I'll be forty-eight." She tutted. "To save you counting on your fingers, that means I'm forty-five now."

"Wow."

"Is that a good wow or a bad wow?"

"A good one. You look amazing."

"Thank you. Do you want me to suck some stiffness back into you yet?"

“What?” He still felt like he’d just run a marathon. “Maybe we could have a bit more pillow talk first.”

“Okay. So, I left school with very good grades and went to university, which over here they seem to call college. In the UK, college is where the underachievers go to get some sort of certificate for doing manual things.”

“Really?”

“No, I’m just being elitist. At university I met people from all over the world and learned how to be very cosmopolitan.”

He turned onto his side so he could watch her face. She really didn’t look forty-five. There were no lines around her eyes, but if she got her body fixed, maybe she’d also had nips, tucks and Botox. “How did you do that?” he asked, wondering if she’d met her American husband there.

“I fucked a French guy because I loved his accent. I fucked a Malaysian guy because he had the most beautiful brown eyes. I overheard a girl I disliked tell her friend that she fancied some Irish guy, so I had him next.”

Tyler laughed out loud.

“What can I say?” Kim shrugged. “I went through a few home-grown guys too, but I also explored Ghana, Belgium and Turkey.”

“I can see I’m out of my league.”

“Of course you are, darling.” She smiled sweetly. “Enjoy it, because you might not get another night like this for quite a while.”

Tyler was thinking maybe he should have insisted on using a condom. He’d had no idea Kim was so promiscuous.

“You wouldn’t believe how many of the guys at Uni were still virgins,” she said. “Apparently when some people were at school, all they did was study.” She looked incredulous, then smiled. “I loved their eagerness, their embarrassment and their expressions of gratitude afterwards. I soon discovered that virgins lasted much longer if I blew them an hour before I rode them.”

Tyler’s cock was starting to tingle again.

“I slept with lecturers to improve my grades, but when I slept with housemates’ boyfriends it restricted my lodging opportunities. During my second year I learned a very valuable lesson.”

“And what was that?”

“Two guys at once give much more than twice the pleasure.”

“You had a threesome in your second year at college?”

“I had several, all with different guys. The one I remember most vividly happened at a fancy-dress party.”

The way she smiled told Tyler she was thinking about it now.

She told him how she’d dressed as a slutty ballerina, describing shoes that looked like leather ballet slippers with a six-inch heel that made it look like she was walking on her toes. “Everything I wore was black — tutu, fishnet hold-ups and boob-tube. The Malaysian guy I’d dated was there with a gorgeous black guy from Ghana. I can’t remember his name, but I remember his body.”

“Why was that one more memorable than the others?”

She sucked her lower lip into her mouth and flashed her eyes. “With the others I’d just sucked and fucked both guys one after the other. But that time...”

A beautiful smile lit up her face, and Tyler could imagine what a stunner she must have been at nineteen.

“It was a barbecue,” she said. “While all the other guests were outside in the garden grilling sausages and burgers, I was bent double upstairs getting my first spit-roast. Afterwards we went downstairs, ate some burnt food then went back to one of their houses and continued the fun. I had my first DP that night, too.”

Tyler was imagining a 19-year-old version of Kim getting nailed front and back. His cock was back to its full glory.

She glanced down at it and smiled. “I don’t think I need to suck that back to life, do I?”

“Maybe it needs sucking just a little bit.”

She let out a throaty chuckle and slid down the bed. Tyler watched her lick up the shaft, then saw her lips open and his cock disappear

completely. He groaned as he felt his tip slide into her tight throat, then groaned again as her tongue moved against the lower side of his shaft. He'd never felt anything so good in his life.

After less than a minute she released it and sat up, a smug look on her face. "If you're a good boy, I'll do it for longer next time."

His mouth opened but no words came out.

"And if you're a very good boy, I'll take you all the way like that."

He closed his mouth and nodded.

She stroked his face. "I like young men. They have endless stamina and do what they're told." She pushed him to the edge of the bed and lay on her back. "Now, let's pretend you're at the gym and about to do some press-ups."

Tyler smirked and when she opened her long, tanned legs he climbed between them.

"Perfect. And just to prove I'm still as supple as I used to be..." She bent at the waist and lifted her legs until they were vertical, the heels of her red shoes pointing towards the ceiling. She rested a calf on each of his shoulders, glanced at her watch and smiled. "Oh look, it's fuck o'clock."

Tyler laughed and guided himself inside her again. Because of the angle, the tip of his cock was sliding against the front wall of her pussy.

Kim held his hips and adjusted herself until it was sliding straight down into her depths, then nodded. "Okay, just keep driving that into me. You can go fast or slow, and you can be rough or gentle. I like it all." She squeezed her legs together and trapped his head between them. "And don't stop until you've come."

He started to fuck her, and she closed her eyes. Resting her hands on his hips, she rocked her body beneath him. He moved slow and gentle at first, enjoying the feeling of his cock sliding in and out of her sticky hole. He could smell her juices and his own sweat. Kim kept her eyes closed, her lower lip between her teeth and her brows knitted like she was concentrating on something.

He was working hard and stepped up the pace a little. Kim let out a guttural moan and rocked her hips faster. Her breathing got deeper and then

he felt the clench of her orgasm. She didn't make a sound apart from breathing heavily through her clenched teeth.

Her eyes snapped open, and she mouthed the word 'harder'. He put more force into each thrust. She gave him an encouraging smile, and he jackhammered her as hard as he could. Her legs gripped his head, and her pussy gripped his cock. She came again, and this time she screamed and scratched at his arms, then started kicking her calves against his shoulders.

Something hit his back and rolled off. It was one of her shoes. He tried to fuck her hard enough to shake the other one off, but then his balls imploded, and he came like a firehose.

He cried out and she jerked beneath him, clenching and releasing, her body never still as she drained him. Finally he stopped moving and stared down at her in awe.

She gave him a smile, then eased him out and lowered her legs.

They settled down side-by-side, and he pulled the sheet over them. He wondered if she'd stay the night, grinning at what Andy would say if Kim walked out of his bedroom and joined them for breakfast.

"Can I ask you more questions?" he said once he'd gotten his breath back.

"Will it help get you hard again?"

He laughed. "Probably."

"Okay then, ask away."

"What did you study at college?"

"It was a university, and I studied economics with mathematics."

"Wow." He remembered she'd mentioned working in finance when they were in the bar. "So what did you do after graduating?"

"I went into banking." She gave him a smile. "And while that's not cockney rhyming slang, it might as well be."

Tyler was puzzled and shook his head to show he wasn't sure what she meant.

"It doesn't matter. What I'm saying is, a lot of the men I encountered only wanted one thing."

“Right.” He didn’t see why this would be a problem to someone who’d apparently spent most of her time in college on her back, and also fucked the professors to improve her grades. “And you didn’t like that?”

“I liked it fine.” Kim smiled, explaining that to work on the projects she wanted, all she’d needed to do was wear a short skirt and high heels.

“That was enough?”

“It was enough to get them alone in an office. Once there, I showed them just how much I knew about my role. I accrued interest, oversaw withdrawals and accepted deposits.”

“You fucked your bosses?”

“I fucked everyone, from the office boy up to the CEO.”

He gave a laugh, but at the same time realised how unimportant he actually was. All she’d wanted was another fuck. She hadn’t even bothered to remember his name. He really should have insisted on wearing a rubber.

“What’s more,” she continued, “if the men were married, it gave me so much more leverage.”

“You blackmailed them?”

“Of course not. But a guy who’s been with the same woman for twenty years will do practically anything for a young woman who’ll let him stick his married cock wherever he wants.”

He didn’t have an answer to that. “And yet you got married.”

“Hmm, I did.”

“But it didn’t work out?”

“On the contrary, it worked out perfectly. Aaron was exactly what I needed.”

“How so?”

“I no longer need to work, darling. My settlement—or alimony as you guys call it—leaves me free to enjoy myself with hot young men like you.”

“You married him for money?”

“In banking, everything’s about money.”

“And love never came into it?”

“I married him because he didn’t want to change me. I’d told him I didn’t see myself as the faithful wife type, and he said that wouldn’t be a problem because he intended still having a little fun of his own.” She gave a smile. “He was older and seemed quite understanding.”

“And that didn’t bother you?”

“Of course not. He proposed in an Italian restaurant, and I’d been flirting with the waiter all evening.” Her face took on a dreamy expression. “Jet black hair and five o’clock shadow. When Aaron got a call he needed to take—he was in banking, too—I snuck into the cloakroom with the waiter.”

“And?”

“When Aaron slipped the 2-carat diamond onto my finger ten minutes later, I still had the taste of the waiter’s cum in my mouth.”

You bitch. “Did you feel guilty?”

She shook her head. “I’d already told him I didn’t consider myself a one-man woman.”

“But to do that on the night he proposed?”

“I told you I was a slut. I’d told him, too.” She shrugged. “And anyway, he hadn’t actually proposed at the time I gave the blowjob.”

“And yet for all his understanding, it didn’t work out.”

“No. It seems that his understanding didn’t stretch as far as I thought. He caught me letting his son fuck me doggy-style at the side of our pool, and that ended our marriage.”

“And now you’re a rich divorcee?”

“Yes. I see myself as a lady of both leisure *and* pleasure.”

“And your ex-husband’s son?”

She smiled. “He’ll get his inheritance, though I think he’s still a little disgruntled that we were interrupted before he got to finish inside his stepmom.”

Tyler stared at her. Kim was probably the most self-centred person he’d ever met. She didn’t seem to care about anything except getting fucked and being rich. He knew he’d never see her again, and that didn’t bother him at all.

Kim was watching him with a look of amusement. She probably didn't care what he thought about her. "Are you ready to come in my mouth now?"

"Is that what you want?"

She regarded him through half-open eyes, then gave his cock a squeeze. "I think it's what you want. But if you'd rather put it somewhere else, I can be flexible."

If he had any self-respect he'd pretend to be too tired, but knew he'd spend the rest of his life regretting it. "Your mouth will be fine."

She rolled over onto his chest and looked into his eyes. "My mouth will be sublime." With that she kissed her way down over his chest and abs, then nuzzled her nose into his pubes. The first lick of her tongue on his balls made him shiver. She took them in her mouth one at a time, then licked slowly up his shaft. By the time her lips slipped down over his glans, he was as hard as he'd ever been in his life.

Kim worked his cock in a way that made him whimper. She used her tongue relentlessly and gently grazed the crown with her teeth. She alternated between sucking hard on the tip and taking him deep. She even wrapped her hair around the base of his shaft and slowly wanked him with it.

Suddenly the sound of the apartment door opening and closing made them both open their eyes. Kim released his cock and looked up at him questioningly.

"That'll be Andy, my roommate."

"Oh." She ran the tip of her tongue around the tip of his cock while looking up into his eyes. "Is Andy as good-looking as you?"

Unbelievable. "So I'm told."

She smiled. "Well, don't feel you have to exclude him on my account."

"It may be hard for you to believe, but you're actually not his type."

"Oh?" She looked more surprised than upset.

Tyler smiled. "Andy's in a steady relationship—"

"He sounds like he's *exactly* my type."

“With a guy called Justin.”

“Ah, right.” She sighed, then gave his cock a squeeze. “Well, there’s plenty here for me.”

He nodded. “Yeah, so stop talking and get back to what you’re good at.”

“And what’s that?”

Being a slut. “Pleasing men.”

She smiled. “Certainly.” She lowered her head and took his full length into her mouth.

No other girl had ever managed to do that, and Tyler couldn’t believe how great it felt. As she began bobbing her head and twisting her neck, he knew that even though she’d drained his balls twice already, it wouldn’t take her long to make him come again.

Kim looked and acted like a porn star, but there was something about the way she used people he didn’t like. He’d hoped to learn her deeper truth from their pillow talk, but all he’d actually learned was that there was no deeper truth. Her entire life had been about her using her body to get what she wanted.

She may have given him the best sex he’d ever had, but he knew that being used as a piece of meat would leave a bitter taste afterwards.

Tyler stopped caring about it and buried his fingers in her hair. Kim dragged her nails down his abs and bobbed her head faster, obviously aware he was getting close. His entire body tensed, then he erupted into her mouth.

Kim moaned theatrically and swept her tongue repeatedly over his sensitive glans. She swallowed with a gulp, then took him into her throat again. Another shudder ran through him, and she moaned again.

With his legs locked straight and jaw clenched tight, it felt as if he was being electrocuted. When the sensation finally passed, his entire body went limp.

She released him from her mouth, ran her tongue around her lips and gave him a smile. “How was that?”

Tyler forced a smile. “Incredible.”

“Hmm.” Looking smug, she stepped off the bed and bent to pick up her purse. “I’m going to call an Uber. What’s your address?”

After giving it to her, he watched her make the call while still naked, then pull on and adjust her dress. Her body was truly amazing. She stepped into her shoes, and he got up and pulled on his boxers before walking her out of his bedroom and to the door. Andy had already gone into his own room.

Kim stepped close and kissed Tyler’s cheek. “Well, I had fun...”

“Me too.” He held her eye. “You taught me something.”

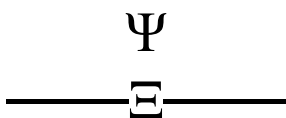
A smile curled her lips. “And what was that?”

“To be really good, sex has to be more than sex.”

She laughed. “You’re young, but you’ll learn.” With that, Kim flashed him one final smile and left.

Tyler decided he was too tired to shower, so headed back to bed.





The Weretwat's Woman

Halfway down their first pint in The Witch's Nipple, Aiden sipped his beer, smiled and leaned closer to Oliver. "I've got something to tell you, Ol, but you're not allowed to repeat it to anyone."

"Yeah? What's that then?"

Aiden allowed himself a smug smile. "Trish thinks I'm a werewolf."

Oliver snorted. "Yeah? Well, I think you're a fanny, and you can repeat that to anyone you like."

"No, I'm serious. She really believes I'm a werewolf."

"Why would she think that, for fuck's sake?"

"I kind of led her on. Dropped subtle hints, gave her a few clues."

Oliver put his glass down and frowned, now convinced that his friend had finally lost his last couple of marbles. "Aid, what the fuck are you going on about?"

Looking around to make sure they weren't being overheard, Aiden grinned. "It's a way of improving the sex we have."

Oliver scoffed, picked up his glass and downed the beer in one go. He held the empty glass up in front of Aiden's face. "D'you think you can manage to buy another round before full moon?"

Aiden snatched the glass from him and went to the bar. A couple of minutes later, he returned with two fresh pints.

Oliver took a sip, the frothy head clinging to his moustache as he put his glass down on the table. He looked at his friend. "So, what were you prattling on about before?"

Aiden took a breath. "Not long after I started seeing Trish, I happened to notice that her bookshelves and Kindle were full of those stupid romance novels about shifters."

"Huh?"

"You know, shape-shifters. Werewolves and shit."

“There’s books like that?”

“Fucking shed-loads of them. Some cunt must turn them out every week – just think of another animal men can turn into and publish the same story time after time.”

Oliver scratched his head. “Romance stories?”

“Yeah.”

“With women fucking animals?”

“What?” Aiden shook his head. “No, you sick twat. The men turn into animals, but they only have sex with women when they’re in their human form.”

“Oh.” Oliver scratched his beard. “I’m not sure I see the point then. They might as well just shag a normal bloke.”

Aiden glared at his friend for a few seconds, then shook his head again. “It’s their hidden strength and that. Women get all hot and gooey at the thought of humping a shape-shifter. It turns them on.”

Oliver was still frowning. “They’d be better off shagging a donkey, or a horse.”

“*What?*”

“You know, they’ve got big cocks and that, and—”

“Ol, you’re missing the point. Women don’t want big hairy quadrupeds with hooves. They want men, but the idea of those men turning into another form gets them frothing at the gash. It seems that men who can turn into wolves, bears, tigers, dragons, or whatever—they’re more desirable.”

“Fish?”

“What?”

“Do men turn into fish? They could have the best of both worlds, fuck women *and* mermaids.”

Aiden shook his head in disbelief. “Stop talking. Anyway, Trish reads those stories, and then she’s like a bitch in heat.”

“Yeah?”

Aiden blew out his cheeks. “I’ll tell you, mate, it gets her wetter than a waterfall.”

Oliver considered this information for a few seconds. Trish was very attractive, and the image of her being sexually aroused was a nice one. “So why not just let her read the books and then, you know...?” He shrugged. “Bathe in her waterfall.”

Aiden smiled and shook his head. “Because it’s so much better if it’s *me* who she’s gagging for, not some fictional shifter in a book.”

Oliver took another gulp of his beer, then shook his head. “But you’re not a shape-shifter. I’ve known you since primary school, and you’ve never been anything but the twat you are now.” He thought for a moment. “When you hit puberty, you were as spotty as fuck. Maybe you were a wereleopard for a couple of years.”

“Fuck off. Anyway, once I realised how horny Trish gets after reading those books, I decided to pretend I was a werewolf.”

“How? Did you start pissing on every tree you passed, chase next door’s cat, and shit on your lawn?”

“Yeah, yeah—laugh all you like. But since I convinced Trish I was a shifter, I’ll bet I’ve had more blowjobs than you’ve ever had.”

Oliver chewed his lower lip while he thought about Trish giving blowjobs. “So, how’d you give the hints, then?”

Aiden grinned. “I started acting a bit weird—”

“Not much of an act, really. You *are* weird.”

“Fuck off, let me finish. I started acting a bit weird when we were out at night. I’d breathe heavier and scratch at my sides if the moon was out, and make excuses for leaving early if there was a full moon.”

Oliver nodded as if he understood the strategy, but his mind was still thinking about the injustice of Trish’s plump, pouty lips sliding up and down on this cretin’s cock.

Aiden was still grinning. “Then I suggested we go to the zoo. I’d bought an electronic dog whistle, one of those things that when you press a button, it emits a sound too high-pitched for humans to hear, but dogs can hear it. I had it in my pocket, and as we walked past the wolf enclosure, I held the button down. They went fucking mental, howling and running round and round like their nuts were on fire. Everyone else stopped and

stared, so I just walked over to them and released the button. They calmed down immediately, like I was a fucking wolf-whisperer or something.”

Oliver was shaking his head. “And you did this because...?”

“Trish blew me off in the zoo carpark. She was digging her nails into my arm as we left the wolves, and rubbing my dick before we’d got out of the exit. As soon as we got in the car, she ripped my jeans open and deep-throated me like she was Linda fucking Lovelace.”

“Wow.”

Aiden nodded. “I thought she was going to suck my bollocks up through my dick. God, I came so hard I nearly fainted.” He took another slug of his beer. “Another time, we were walking through the park. It was getting dark, so we sneaked into the bandstand for a quickie. I bent her over the railing, hoisted up her skirt, and fucked her from behind. I was just getting to the vinegar stroke when the moon came out from behind a cloud. So I howled, and she came immediately. She clamped so tight I thought her twat was going to throttle my cock. It was almost too painful to pump her full of jizz, but I managed it in the end.” Aiden grinned manically.

Oliver was just about to answer when he saw Trish walk into the pub.

She smiled and headed towards them. “Hello you two.”

Aiden stood up and kissed her cheek. “Hiya. You’re early.”

“Yeah, Liz had to go and pick her sister up from the station, so we cut our drinks night short. Nice to see you again, Ollie.”

“Hiya.” Oliver wondered what it’d be like to slide his dick between those thick, smiling lips.

Aiden went to the bar to get his girlfriend a drink, and Trish perched on the stool next to Oliver.

“So,” she said, “how’ve you been keeping?”

“I’m okay, thanks,” he said, when what he really wanted to do was tell her that Aiden wasn’t a werewolf at all—that he was actually a weretwat. And that Aiden had been a weretwat since they were both five years old.

Trish smiled and crossed her legs. “Have you lost weight, Ollie?”

“Er, yeah, a bit.” He couldn’t decide which was the sexier, her smile or the crossing of her legs. “I, er, started going to the gym.” He nodded. “Bit of exercise, brings out the animal in me.”

Trish laughed and placed her hand on his arm. “Don’t tell me that, you’ll make me all weak at the knees.”

Just then, Aiden returned with Trish’s Bloody Mary. “Here you go, pet.”

She flashed him a smile. “Thanks.”

Aiden dropped back into his seat and glared at Oliver, telling him with his eyes that what they’d discussed earlier was to remain private.

Trish nodded in Oliver’s direction. “I was just telling Ollie that he’s looking fit.”

Aiden looked at his friend, then scoffed. “Yeah, but I’m not sure what he’s fit for.”

Trish giggled and slapped Aiden’s arm. “Don’t be horrible.” She turned to Oliver. “He doesn’t deserve to have a friend like you.”

Ollie smiled and looked down at his feet, wondering how Aiden had ever managed to get off with someone as nice as Trish.

“Come on,” Aiden said. “I’m in the mood for a walk in the fresh air. I can’t stand being cooped up inside on a nice, clear night.”

Trish glanced at Oliver. “What about Ollie?”

“He’ll be alright. He can play darts or something.”

She frowned, and Oliver insisted it was fine, that he’d be leaving soon as he was going to the gym next morning.

Aiden led Trish out of the pub and away from the town centre. “If we walk down here, we can cut across the school field. Then maybe call for chips after, if we work up an appetite.”

She laughed and followed behind him.

Once they were in the shadow of the school gym, Aiden stopped and pulled her close, pushing his groin against hers. “All this fresh air is getting me going,” he said, scratching her sides and panting a little, for effect.

“Oh is it?” She pulled back and looked at him. “And what part exactly is it that’s going?”

Her eyes seemed to sparkle, and Aiden wondered if they were reflecting the flashing red light from the alarm on the side of the building.

He growled and pumped his hips. “I need my bitch.”

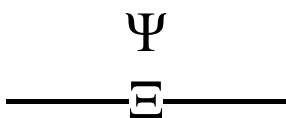
“Ah, I see. You need your *bitch*.” She tilted her head to one side and looked at him. “Well, I would have liked to have finished my drink. And another Bloody Mary might have been nice, but I guess I’ll have to make do with my bloody boyfriend.”

Aiden’s brow furrowed as he puzzled over what she’d meant. Then something in her mouth changed. He thought it must have been a trick of the light, because what looked like two fangs had just appeared behind her lips. He was just about to say something when Trish snapped her head forward and pierced his neck.

Aiden felt his life-force ebbing away and realised it would soon be all over.

He knew better than anyone just how hard Trish could suck.





Role Reversal

Ruth studied the woman from the chair at the side of their bed. She'd introduced herself as Tanya, but that probably wasn't her real name. Her face was pretty enough not to need all the makeup, but Ruth could tell Michael liked it. He also seemed enthralled by her spray-tanned body and peroxide blonde hair. Tanya was on all fours on the bed with Michael kneeling behind, admiring her raised backside.

He ran a hand over the smooth flesh and looked towards his wife. "This is what an arse should feel like—smooth like a peach, not dimpled like orange peel."

He reached forward and cupped Tanya's pert breasts in his hands. "Wow, these are so firm. Nothing like those saggy creased bags you call tits."

Ruth looked down at her own breasts beneath the shapeless dressing gown, then back at Tanya's. The girl had a really good body, but then she was about fifteen years younger and almost certainly hadn't breast-fed two children.

Michael's cock was harder than Ruth had seen it in a long time. As he ran his hand up the inside of Tanya's thigh, he sneered in Ruth's direction. "She's oozing juice already, just from the thought of getting my cock." He rubbed his fingertips together, examining the consistency of her secretions. "This is how a woman's body should respond."

Tanya let out a sigh as Michael glided a finger between her labia. She opened her kohl-lined eyes and stared at Ruth while her husband fingered her from behind. When he positioned himself ready for penetration, Tanya took her lower lip between her teeth.

Ruth watched the other woman's eyelashes flutter as her husband slid his cock home.

"Ah, fuck." Michael exhaled, the rapture of being sheathed in a twenty-one-year-old vagina shining from his eyes. He pulled back slightly,

then lunged forward.

Ruth saw the shockwave run through Tanya's firm hips, heard her sob as Michael's cock stretched those innermost places.

"She's so tight." He withdrew and pushed into her again and again. "Wet and tight and *so* fucking hot." He glanced at Ruth. "Much better than that dried-up, withered purse you've got between your legs."

Tanya lowered her head to the mattress. "Oh yeah. God, that feels so good."

Ruth regarded her husband, his lips drawn back as he gasped through clenched teeth. He was approaching his orgasm. She'd seen that face often, but not for a long time.

A sob escaped Tanya's lips, then she whimpered and moaned.

Michael suddenly opened his eyes and stared at his wife. "She's coming. I can feel her tightening around me. She's going to squeeze the cum out of me..."

"Oh, oh, oh." Tanya's eyes were closed, and her pouty lips were wide open. Ruth begrudgingly admired the woman's sexiness.

"Fuck!" Michael dropped his head back and held himself still. Tanya howled as she received his gift, her microbladed eyebrows knitting together as she rocked and rolled those perfect hips.

"Oh yeah. Fucking hell, I'm still pumping jizz into her." He nodded to his wife. "She's milking me dry, sucking every drop out of me." He sighed, then took a deep breath. "This makes your performances look a bit lame, don't you think? Makes you seem like a rubber fucking doll, how you just lie there. Makes you seem like a corpse."

Ruth bit her lip and watched as the pair on the bed finally stopped thrusting and wriggling. She'd actually enjoyed watching, but mainly because she found Tanya so sexy.

Michael withdrew, exiting the young woman's clean-shaven cunt with an audible plop. He leaned back on his haunches and looked at his wife. "Come here and lick my cock. Find out what a real woman tastes like."

Ruth hesitated for only a second, then stood and placed her hands on the mattress. She leaned down and looked at her husband's softening cock.

It was slick with Tanya's juices, and a sliver of his cum still hung from the tip. She pushed out her tongue and ran it over the shaft, savouring the taste of the other woman.

Michael nodded towards Tanya's still-raised rear end. "And look at that."

Ruth saw a huge glob of cum ooze out.

"See?" He sounded so proud of himself. "That's what I gave her. That's my creampie dripping from her well-fucked cunt. I never come anything like as much as that when I'm in your slack bag of a twat."

Ruth marvelled at the volume and was secretly impressed, though she was confident Tanya would elicit similar amounts from all her lovers.

"Well, I think I'll go for a bath." Michael got off the bed and smiled. "Tanya, it's been a pleasure."

Ruth saw the young woman flash him a smile.

When Michael returned to the bedroom thirty minutes later, Ruth was alone. She'd applied foundation, blusher, eyeshadow and mascara. She'd also pinned her hair up and painted her lips with scarlet gloss.

Watching his face as he took in her tight white top, hip-hugging short black skirt and black stilettos, she waited until he looked into her eyes. "Did you enjoy yourself earlier?"

"Yes." He smiled, sheepishly. "She was rather attractive, don't you think?"

Ruth nodded. "She was gorgeous. And the sex?"

"Heavenly. I needed the release."

"Yeah, I can imagine. It's been a while. What about humiliating me in front of her—did you enjoy that?"

He frowned and shook his head. "No, not really. I felt guilty."

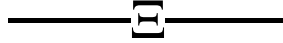
"Hmm. It can be hard at first."

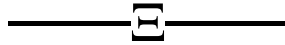
He looked concerned. "Did I sound awfully contrived?"

She shook her head. "No, you did fine—and you stayed in character. I'm sure Tanya thinks that's who you are, what you're like all the time."

He smiled, obviously abashed. "Thank you."

Ruth checked her reflection in the mirror. “Right, I think you’d better get your cage back on and sit in the chair. My bull will be here in five minutes.”





Natural Selection

Scott convened with the other tourists in the restaurant at 6:30 am. They'd arrived at the hotel the previous night and, like everyone else, he was excited about what lay in store.

A tall, handsome black man in khaki shirt and shorts strode to the centre of the room. "Good morning," he said, flashing them a wide, friendly smile. "Welcome to Mugumu. I trust you are all well-rested after yesterday's journey. I know for many of you, the five-hour coach trip from Moshi came after long flights, but I'm sure the views of Mount Kilimanjaro from the air made it all worthwhile."

There were murmurs of agreement and nodding heads among the tourists.

"My name is Victor, and I will be overseeing your visit to Serengeti National Park."

Another hum of excited chatter came from the assembled guests. Scott glanced around at his fellow travellers. The majority were Brits, but there was also a Dutch couple he'd spoken to yesterday, and two French girls who looked to be around his age.

Scott had recently graduated from university and had booked the holiday on impulse after he and Janice had been offered positions at opposite ends of the country. She'd said their relationship had been fun while they were both studying in Exeter, but she didn't see them as a long-term couple. So when she opted for a PR job in Suffolk, Scott had accepted an offer for a master's course in St Andrew's. He'd been enamoured with Africa since he was a kid, so a safari holiday seemed like the perfect way to start the next part of his life.

Victor was speaking again. "As a Tanzanian, it would probably be a little egotistical for me to tell you that the Serengeti is the greatest place in the entire world to see wild animals." He flashed another winning smile. "But it is."

Giggles rippled through the guests.

"Serengeti is home to over one and a half million wildebeest, half a million Thomson and Grant's gazelle, and two hundred thousand zebra. And because of all these migrating ungulates, it has the greatest concentration of predators in the world." His eyes widened. "There are over seven thousand hyenas, four thousand lions and six hundred cheetahs. If you are lucky, you may also see some of the rarer animals such as the leopard and the rhinoceros."

Having seen endless documentaries about Africa, Scott was excited about witnessing all these wonders of the natural world with his own eyes. Seeing animals in a zoo wasn't the same as seeing them in their natural habitat, though he knew that witnessing a kill was unlikely. Filmmakers spent months capturing the footage for the programmes he loved watching.

"We have five very knowledgeable tour guides who will drive you through the park and point out all the wonderful things there are to see," Victor said proudly. "If you would all like to help yourselves to some breakfast, we will choose groups to travel together. There are numerous luxury camps within the Serengeti, and you will stay there tonight and tomorrow night, though different parties will be at different sites. After breakfast you will be introduced to your guide, who will drive the forty-kilometre journey to the Fort Ikoma gate to the Serengeti. Thank you."

As Victor made his way to a group of other people in khaki, presumably the guides, Scott looked around for the French girls. He figured that being in the same tour group as them would give him something to look at when the wildlife was being elusive. As it was, he saw they were at a table that was already full, so once he'd served himself bacon, eggs, sausage and hashbrowns he sat with a group of Brits which included two couples who'd obviously travelled together.

They all made polite conversation as they ate, each excited about what lay ahead, and then when more coffee was served Victor reappeared and started reading out names and giving them a number; Scott was in

Group 2. He was disappointed when he heard the French girls being allocated into Group 4.

Their cases had already been loaded into the Land Rovers, and Scott went to stand at the side of the beige long wheel-based vehicle with a handwritten number two clipped under the windscreen wiper. There were four other people already there, all men in their twenties or early thirties.

Scott smiled. "Hi guys, I'm Scott."

The others nodded and called out their own names. Ben had a Scottish accent, Alan sounded like he came from the London area, and Tony and Pete didn't seem to have any regional accent, but they were undoubtedly English.

"Hello," said a female voice. They turned to look in her direction and were met by a smiling woman dressed in khaki shirt and shorts with lace-up Caterpillar work boots. "My name's Claudia, and I'm your guide for today."

Scott guessed she was around forty. Her blonde hair was pinned up and a pair of sunglasses were pushed up onto the top of her head. She wore no makeup but didn't need it. She had big blue eyes, her face was tanned, and there was a smattering of freckles across her cheeks and the bridge of her nose.

They mumbled a greeting, and Claudia opened one of the Land Rover's rear doors. "If you gentlemen would like to climb into the back, we'll get on our way. Should any of you wish to visit the toilets before we leave, I suggest you do so now." She gave them a smile, then lowered her sunglasses and climbed into the driver's seat.

Scott had just used the loo so he climbed into the Land Rover. There were two rows of three seats and he sat in the row at the very back. Pete slid in beside him, and the other three guys headed back inside to the toilets. Alan emerged first, climbing in and taking a seat in front of Scott. Ben followed just behind, and he sat next to Alan.

When Tony got to the vehicle he slammed the rear door and climbed into the passenger seat beside Claudia. "Is it okay if I sit up front with you?" he asked, a confident smile on his face. "I'm sure the view will be much better from here."

Claudia gave a little shrug. She selected first gear, pulled out of the hotel grounds and onto the road.

Scott could see Tony stealing glances down at Claudia's legs, and he had no doubt that everyone else in the truck—including her—was aware of it as well. The guy wasn't being exactly subtle.

Tony oozed a certain kind of self-confidence. He was a few years older than Scott, probably somewhere in his late twenties. The shape of his body suggested he was a regular gym user; his arms had bulging muscles and numerous tattoos. His hair was buzzed short and his t-shirt was made of some stretchy material to emphasise his wide shoulders and narrow waist.

Scott considered the other three guys more normal. During the drive, the four of them chatted and he learned that Alan was a teacher from Brentford, Ben was a chef in a Glasgow restaurant, and Pete worked in a wildlife safari park in Somerset.

"So this is like a working holiday," Scott said.

Pete laughed. "I love my job and I love Africa. This is my third trip. I went to South Africa four years ago and Botswana just before Covid stopped travel."

"Whereabouts in Botswana did you go?" Claudia asked.

"The Okavango Delta."

She gave an approving nod. "Cool. I've worked there. Definitely worth a visit." She glanced at them in the rear-view mirror. "Have any of you got other trips planned while you're here?"

Scott nodded. "I'm going to the Ngorongoro Crater, and then have a few days on Zanzibar at the end of my stay."

"Wow, you're in for a great time."

They fell into silence and Scott watched the scenery, looking out for any signs of wildlife. Claudia slowed the vehicle and pulled onto a long, straight road. After a mile or so, Scott saw the tall wooden structure built over the road and the sign Serengeti National Park. His heart began to race.

While Claudia went to sort out the paperwork, the five men got out of the Land Rover to stretch their legs. Scott climbed to the top of a small rise of rock and looked out over the sweeping landscape that stretched all the way to the horizon. From his reading, he knew the Serengeti was almost

15,000 square kilometres, so they'd only get to see a fraction of it during their two-day visit.

Claudia returned and they all climbed back into the Land Rover. When Tony tried to get back in the front, she told him he'd be better off in the back because the roof could be raised so the animals could be viewed on all sides. She opened the roof catches at the front and asked the men in the back to do the same with the central and rear ones. The roof of the Land Rover was raised then by about a foot, held in place by six metal arms.

With all the men now in the back, they pulled through the big gates and drove into the place where Scott had dreamed of visiting for years.

The first wildlife they encountered was a small herd of Grant's gazelles. Claudia proved knowledgeable and recited facts about the animals and their habits. According to her, unlike the more water-dependent zebra, wildebeest and Thomson gazelle, Grant's tended not to migrate to follow the rains because they could get what water they needed by eating leafy materials.

A shout from Alan alerted them to several elephants walking through the grass to their right. Claudia stopped the vehicle and three of the guys took out their cameras and clicked off a few photos.

"Tembo," Claudia said with a smile. "That's their Swahili name. African elephants are the largest land mammal on the planet, bigger than their Asian cousins."

After a few minutes they drove further into the park. The first carnivore they saw was a black-backed jackal, and a few minutes later they happened upon a lone hyena. It was fifteen minutes later when Ben spotted the first lions. There were three of them, two females and a male, lying in the shade of a tree.

Claudia picked up her binoculars and studied them. "Simba."

Pete nodded. "Like The Lion King."

"Yes," Claudia agreed. "Quite a few of the animal names in that movie come from Swahili terms." She gave a smile. "Why think up fictitious names when the perfect ones exist in the local language? The word 'safari' actually means 'trip' in Swahili."

Everyone took numerous photos. When the lions showed no sign of moving, Claudia continued along the track. Over the next couple of hours they saw wildebeest, buffalo, Thomson and Grant's gazelle and zebra. Numerous birds of prey circled above them. A Martial eagle took off from a nearby tree stump only a few yards away from their truck. Three giraffes walked lazily across the road, and Scott was thrilled when one stopped under a nearby acacia tree to nibble at its leaves. A little later they spotted a cheetah, or 'duma' as Claudia called it.

With each new sighting, Claudia smiled at the men's reactions. They came to a place where several other trucks were parked on a flat patch of grass, and Claudia announced it was lunchtime.

"I suggest we eat before we go over there," she said, indicating a wooden fence with about twenty tourists taking photos.

The hotel had made them all a packed lunch, and they ate on the grass by the side of the Land Rover. Once they'd had their fill, Claudia led them over to the wooden fence which lined a path overlooking a small lake. The lake was full of hippos, and the smell was disgusting. The entire surface was covered with a layer of faeces, and as Scott watched, one hippo took a shit and spun its tail to scatter the mess over the water.

"That's fucking disgusting," Tony said.

Claudia smiled. "It's their way of marking their territory to ward off other males, and also to attract the attention of females."

"I can't see that method working for me," Ben said.

She laughed. "A hippo can defecate up to eight hundred pounds of waste a day."

Tony grimaced as he watched the hippos for a while. "So the males guard their territory and their females?"

Claudia nodded. "The dominant male can have anywhere between two and thirty hippos living in his territory."

"Nice."

"You think?" Claudia asked.

"Yeah, he gets to choose which female he services, and they're lucky enough to get the alpha. The biggest, baddest and strongest boy in the pool."

“If you say so.”

They headed back to the Land Rover a few minutes later, calling at a nearby shady stream where they saw half a dozen crocodiles sleeping on the mud bank. They watched them for almost ten minutes and none of the crocodiles moved a muscle. Then they headed back to the grasslands and caught sight of a warthog and a group of banded mongoose.

There were a lot of other Land Rovers around and when they came to several parked in a line, Claudia slowed down.

“Looks like there must be something to see,” she said.

Sure enough, there was a dead buffalo with six lions feeding on the carcass about thirty yards off the dirt track. Sitting at the edge of the clearing were two jackals, hoping for scraps. The men in the Land Rover watched through binoculars and took countless photographs, then moved on again.

“So,” Tony said, leaning forward over the front passenger seat to talk to Claudia. “I guess the lion is the ultimate alpha. King of the jungle and all that. Surely any female would like to be under his protection.”

Claudia gave him an amused smile. “It’s the lionesses that do ninety percent of the hunting, yet the male demands all the choice parts from the kill, like the heart, liver and kidneys. And when the old lion is finally deposed by a younger, stronger rival, the new leader will kill any cubs fathered by the old lion. If you ask me, the lionesses would be better off living without a male.” She flashed a smile. “Have you seen the size of a lioness’s tongue?”

Scott and the other men laughed, but Tony shook his head as if the thought of any species not requiring a strong alpha male was abhorrent. “They couldn’t survive without his protection.”

Claudia nodded. “You’re right. I was just yanking your chain.”

Over the next twenty minutes they saw more zebra, wildebeest and gazelle, then she stopped and pointed to a tree. A dead antelope hung from a branch over five metres up from the ground. Several hyenas were patrolling around the trunk.

“A leopard kill,” she said. “They’re ambush predators. Probably made the kill last night and dragged it up there to keep it out of the way of

the hyenas.”

Pete was nodding. “Leopards are amazing. They can climb trees with a kill heavier than themselves in their jaws.”

Claudia nodded, then looked at Tony. “Now, spotted hyenas are an interesting species. The females are bigger and stronger than the males, and each pack is led by a dominant female. They have the ultimate FLR.”

“What’s FLR?” Tony asked.

“Female-Led Relationship. Spotted hyenas have more girl power than all The Spice Girls put together.”

Tony scoffed, shaking his head as if he thought she was winding him up.

Claudia pointed at one particular hyena. “She’s the leader.”

The men looked at the hyenas. Scott zoomed his binoculars in on the head of the biggest one. It had old battle scars on its face and slobber drooling from the mouth. The smell of the dead antelope was probably driving it mad.

“If a lion comes along,” Claudia said, “it’ll climb the tree and steal the feast. Hyenas can’t climb, and leopards know that.”

“I think you need to check your guide books again,” Tony said with a smug grin. “That *female* hyena’s packing meat and two veg.”

“Yes,” Claudia agreed. “Female spotted hyenas have a phallus-like pseudopenis. It can extend, retract and even become erect. She uses it to pee, signal and will even anally mount males and females as a show of dominance.” She grinned. “Imagine that, Tony, being pegged every time you got out of line or forgot your place in the pecking order.”

Tony obviously didn’t believe her. “But it’s got bollocks, too.”

“That’s her labia. Her pseudopenis is actually her clitoris. Just think, a female with a clitoris the same length and girth as the male penis.”

Scott got the impression Claudia enjoyed teasing Tony.

“When hyenas mate, she retracts her pseudopenis and the male slips his inside. The bad news is that she also has to give birth through it. Imagine pushing a baby out of your dick.”

All the men in the Land Rover shuddered.

Claudia laughed at their reaction. “It’s estimated that fifteen percent of female spotted hyenas die during their first birth, and sixty percent of the young don’t make it, either. But their bits get stretched, and subsequent births are less traumatic, for the mothers *and* their young.”

The sun was now low in the sky. Claudia selected first gear and moved along the dirt track, leaving the hyenas looking hungrily up at the suspended antelope. “Tonight we’ll be staying in one of the campsites within the park, and we need to be there before sunset.”

Scott looked at his watch; it was still relatively early.

Claudia noticed. “We’re close to the equator here, so there’s always about twelve hours between sunrise and sunset. I know at the poles you can get endless days or endless nights depending on the time of year, but here it stays the same all year long.”

As they came out of a cluster of trees, Claudia pointed to their right. “That’s where we’ll be staying tonight.”

The camp was set atop a hill. There was a big building, and then a line of canvas structures built up on wooden stilts. They each had a balcony that looked over the savannah.

When they reached the camp, several African porters walked over to greet them. Some were Maasai, dressed in traditional brightly coloured robes. They had high, prominent cheekbones and their hair was buzzed short. Each smiled brightly, taking the guests’ bags and leading them to the large building where they checked in.

Claudia handed two keys to Scott. “You have two lodges, one sleeps two, the other three. I suggest you guys sort it out among yourselves. Have a rest and shower, and we’ll meet back here in an hour.”

The men nodded.

“And don’t leave the lodge without a porter. Open your door and wave, and one of them will come and escort you.”

“Why?” Tony asked.

“Because we’re in the middle of the Serengeti, where wild animals have to kill to eat.”

“Oh, right.”

Scott was relieved when Ben and Alan suggested the three of them take the larger lodge, and Pete looked a little peeved at being stuck with Tony. The lodge was amazing inside, even though the sides and roof were simply canvas. The floor was polished wooden boards, and there were ceiling fans suspended from the wooden frame to cool it down. Three king-sized beds with mosquito nets took up most of the floor area, but there was also a wooden-framed suite and a coffee table. The shower was a stone circular building attached to the side, with one half of the wall only four feet high so that you could look out over the Serengeti while taking a shower.

Once they were all showered and changed, Scott waved for a porter and they were escorted down the path toward the central building. The dark sky was studded with stars.

Inside, they found Tony and Pete were already at a table with a bottle of beer each. The three guys ordered the same, and a waitress brought over their drinks.

“What do you think of the lodges?” Scott asked the two guys.

“Fabulous,” Pete said. “Do you have an open-plan shower?”

The others nodded.

“What d’you think of Claudia?” Tony asked.

“She’s great,” Pete said. “Certainly knows her stuff.”

“I reckon she’s probably a dyke.”

Scott scoffed. “What makes you think that?”

“Just a vibe she gives off. I can tell.”

Ben chuckled. “So any woman who doesn’t swoon over your muscles must be batting for the other team?”

Just then, Claudia walked into the restaurant with another tour guide. He was a big black guy dressed in a similar khaki uniform to the one she’d worn all day, but she was now dressed in a tight-fitting dress and open-toed sandals. She wore her hair down and had applied a little makeup, notably mascara and red lip-gloss.

As she approached their table, Tony whispered, “Fucking hell.”

“Hi guys,” she said with a smile. “How are the lodges?”

The men muttered positive responses, but Scott could tell that they were all as shocked as he was by how different she looked. Today she'd seemed bigger, almost masculine in her work-boots and khakis. Tonight she seemed so much smaller, which was emphasised by the size of the guy standing next to her. She was really petite, with small breasts and a tiny waist, though the swell of her hips was womanly and feminine.

"Is it okay with you if Demi joins us tonight?" she asked, tipping her head in the direction of her companion.

Everyone nodded.

"Good. He's a guide with the same company, and he's also my husband."

This revelation certainly trashed the lesbian theory, and Ben grinned broadly at Tony to let him know it.

Once they were all seated and had drinks, Demi asked about the things they'd seen on their first day in the Serengeti. All the guys told him about the animals they'd seen and how much they were enjoying it.

"I love the smell of the place," Pete said. "The air smells different in Africa."

"It certainly smelled different around those hippos," Tony said.

Demi chuckled. He looked nothing like the Maasai porters at the camp. His skin was several shades lighter, and while they were tall and slender, Demi was much broader across the shoulders and would probably be considered overweight because of the extra padding around the middle. His wide face and big brown eyes were friendly, and he smiled often. Scott liked him immediately.

Over the next hour they ate and chatted about Africa and all the wonders to be seen. Once dinner was finished they had more drinks. After a while, Claudia brought up the subject of Tony's comments about dominant males.

Tony shrugged. "I think it's a matter of natural selection. The survival of the fittest."

Claudia turned to her husband. "He seemed so interested in the theory, I wondered if he had an alpha male waiting for him back at home."

Ben spat out his beer, and all the others laughed. Scott wasn't sure if they were laughing at Ben's reaction to Claudia's jibe, or the idea of Tony being a bigger man's little bitch. Nobody mentioned Tony's earlier comment about her sexuality.

"That's certainly not the case," Tony said, smiling. He turned to Demi. "Your wife seemed quite taken with spotted hyena society, where the females have a cock they use on other females *and* males."

Demi laughed out loud. "I think maybe she's happy to see the females getting the upper hand." He picked up his beer. "The animal I suspect she admires most when it comes to breeding habits would be the lemon shark."

Claudia looked at her husband with wide eyes.

The five men glanced at each other, then looked back at Claudia and Demi.

"Why?" Tony asked.

Claudia took a sip of her wine, then leaned forward. "What do you guys know about lemon sharks?"

Scott remembered something from one of the many documentaries he'd watched over the years. "They have live young, rather than eggs."

Claudia gave him a beautiful smile. "Correct. Yes, while some sharks have eggs, others produce live young." She frowned. "Actually, all sharks lay eggs, but in some species the eggs hatch inside the female. The young get nutrients by eating the egg yolk, unfertilised eggs and even their siblings." She turned to Tony. "But I suspect Demi was referring to the female lemon shark's mating habits."

"Does she peg the males, like the hyena?" he asked with a smirk on his face.

"Ah, Tony." She narrowed her eyes and smiled. "I can see this is something you are *very* curious about."

Ben was nodding. "Aye, man. What is it that appeals to you about getting your arse-parts reamed?"

"That's not what—"

Claudia laughed again. "Tony, we're winding you up."

“So,” Scott said, “what is it about the lemon shark’s mating habits that Demi referred to?”

Claudia held Scott’s gaze for a moment, and he noticed her cheeks were a little flushed. Either the wine had gone to her head, or she was blushing a little.

She took another sip from her glass, then looked at each man in turn. “There’s something special about a lemon shark’s vagina.”

Tony snorted. “I think there’s something special about *every* vagina.”

“Hmm, you’re probably right, but a lemon shark’s is more special than most, and I consider it to be the ultimate example of natural selection.”

Their table was one of only three still occupied in the restaurant. Claudia glanced around, then back at the men. “I think we’re in danger of overstaying our welcome. The staff have to clear up and be ready to start breakfast at six in the morning.”

The men were all noticeably disappointed because hearing Claudia talk about the sex lives of animals was clearly having an effect on them.

“Maybe we could adjourn to our tent,” Ben suggested. Nodding at the empty wine bottle on the table, he added, “We could ask for another couple of these to take back while you explain what it is about lemon sharks that’s so appealing.”

A look passed between Claudia and her husband, then she smiled. “That’s a good idea. You get the wine, I’ll get one of the porters to show us back to your lodge.”

As the Maasai porter led them back to the lodge, Demi said something to him. The guy turned on his torch and aimed the beam down the side of the hill, picking out two buffalo grazing less than twenty yards away from the path. Just behind them was a hyena.

“That’s why you don’t come out of the lodges on your own at night,” Claudia told them.

Once inside, Ben poured the wine and everyone found somewhere to sit. Claudia and Demi sat on the couch, Alan and Tony took the chairs while Scott, Pete and Ben sat on the mat on the opposite side of the coffee table to the couch. They talked about how the hyenas approached the camp,

and Demi said that sometimes the kitchen staff threw out leftover meat for them.

“So,” Tony said, bringing the topic of conversation back. “You were telling us about lemon sharks, or to be more accurate, the lemon shark’s twat.”

Claudia giggled, and again Scott wondered how drunk she was. She wasn’t slurring her words, but she certainly seemed more flirtatious than she had during the day’s safari.

“Well,” she said, “the correct term is actually the cloaca. The opening is shared by her genitalia, urinary and intestinal tracts. What’s special about a female lemon shark’s is that it can keep live sperm inside it for several days.”

A silence settled over the room. Everyone stared at Claudia, and the atmosphere felt charged.

She looked at the men. “Why should the female only take the biggest, baddest—and possibly ugliest—shark when she can take them all, one after the other? In the case of the lemon shark, the battle of the strongest is played out within the female’s body. She can have a dozen different strains of sperm inside her, and only the strongest will fertilise the eggs.”

Nobody interrupted her.

“Survival of the fittest isn’t something that needs to be done at adult level,” Claudia said with a whisper. “In the animal kingdom, dominance is often achieved by eating the most and growing the strongest. But that doesn’t mean their DNA is the best. For me, the lemon shark’s method is the type of natural selection that appeals the most. So...” She raised her glass. “To lemon sharks, and the women who mimic them.”

Everyone in the room drank to her toast, but Scott doubted that anyone else was still thinking about sharks. Had Claudia just confessed to being the sort of woman who took several men one after the other?

“So what do you guys think?” she asked. “Don’t you prefer the idea of not having to fight for the privilege to fuck?”

Every time she used a crude word, Scott could see the other men, especially Tony, becoming more enthralled.

“Don’t male lemon sharks have to fight to get their chance?” Alan asked.

She shook her head. “Why would they? They know she’ll be up for taking them all. So they just bide their time, gliding through the shallow water off some tropical beach and watching her take shark after shark, knowing that they’ll soon get their turn to fuck her.”

All the men remained completely silent.

“What do you think, Tony?” she teased. “Do you think a dominant alpha would turn his nose up at the chance to mate with a female who’s already got several shots of spunk inside her?”

“No,” he said quietly. “I think he’d be more than happy to wait his turn to add his own shot.”

Claudia smiled, then leaned back on the couch, looked at Demi and raised her eyebrows. He got up from the couch and walked over to a set of shelves, picked up a pack of cards and walked back to stand next to the coffee table. After sorting out five cards, he shuffled them in his hands and held them out, face down, to the men. They took one each. Scott’s heart was racing, and he wondered if the other men felt the same. The moment felt surreal.

“Show me your cards,” Claudia whispered.

Each man placed his card face up on the table. They were all hearts, running from the ace to the five. Scott had the four, Tony the two.

Claudia looked at Alan, who’d drawn the ace. “That means you get to go first.” She got up from the couch and stepped out from behind the coffee table so she was a few feet away from all the men. Then she turned and stood perfectly still. Every man there seemed to be holding his breath. After glancing at her husband, she pulled down the zip under her left arm and let her dress slide down to her feet. She wore only a white thong. Her small breasts were pert with raised, dark pink nipples.

“You can all move closer to watch,” she said. “But remember, while the female lemon shark is enjoying each male, she doesn’t like it if the others get impatient and try to interfere. She’s liable to bite.”

She was warning them not to try and make up a threesome or foursome, but to wait their turn. Claudia bent and slipped off her thong,

leaving it and her shoes with dress on the floor. She held out her hand to Alan. He rose slowly from his chair and they walked to one of the large beds, Alan fully dressed and Claudia, looking tiny and perfect, completely naked. When Demi stood up, the other men followed his lead. They stopped six feet from the bed.

Claudia sat on the edge of the bed and smiled up at Alan. “Are you comfortable with an audience?”

He shrugged. “I’m not sure.”

She reached out and deftly undid the buttons of his jeans. “Ignore them. This isn’t a performance—I just want you to enjoy yourself.” She released his semi-hard cock and gripped it in her hand. Looking up into his eyes, she slowly moved her head forward and took him into her mouth. She kept her eyes fixed on Alan’s while she sucked him. By the time she released him from her mouth, he was fully erect.

Still gripping his cock in her hand, she turned to speak to all the men. “Just to be clear, I don’t want any of you to worry about giving me pleasure or making me feel good. I have a husband who can do that better than anyone I’ve ever met. Tonight I want to be used for your pleasure.” She looked from one man to the other. “I don’t want to be made love to, I want to be fucked.” Her eyes finally settled on Alan. She released his cock, scooted herself back onto the bed and lay on her back. Never taking her gaze of Alan’s face, she slowly spread her legs.

Alan glanced in the men’s direction, but Scott thought he was looking only at Demi as if waiting for permission. Demi offered him a smile, and Alan eased his jeans down his thighs and clambered onto the bed. When Demi edged closer, the others followed suit. Demi, Tony and Pete moved to one side of the bed, Scott and Ben to the other.

As Alan prepared to enter Claudia, she looked up into his face and licked her lips. When he pushed in, her eyes closed and her mouth dropped open. She let out a breathy sigh. Without any preamble, Alan moved into a fast rhythm and fucked her with considerable fervour. Claudia bent her knees and moved with him, her hands gripping his shirt as she raised her groin to meet his thrusts.

The night was warm and Alan soon started sweating, a dark stain appearing on the back of his shirt. He'd been inside her for only a few minutes when he let out a growl, pushed in deep and held still. Claudia continued to wriggle beneath him, whispering words of encouragement. Alan resumed his thrusts, and Claudia writhed and groaned until he eventually stopped and pulled out. Climbing off the bed, Alan avoided eye contact with the other men as he silently tucked his cock away and fastened his jeans.

"Who's next?" Claudia asked.

Tony held up his playing card, a grin on his face.

"Ah, the self-appointed alpha." Claudia rolled over onto her front and got up onto all fours. "I think you should take me doggy-style."

Tony pulled his t-shirt over his head and walked to the foot of the bed. Then he shrugged off his shoes, trousers, and boxers, and climbed naked onto the bed between her feet. As well as the tattoos on his arms, there were more on his chest, back and even his thighs. After positioning the tip of his cock between her outer lips, he gripped her hips and stabbed into her with force. Claudia raised her head and cried out like a wolf baying at the moon.

Tony must have taken her request to heart because his actions suggested it was all about getting his own pleasure. What's more, he thrust so hard it was like he was trying to hurt her. He pounded into her, using his hands to pull her hips back to meet his thrusts. Claudia's entire body shook under his onslaught. Tony was working hard and soon began to perspire, a thin sheen of sweat coating his body.

"Harder," she rasped, now pushing herself back to meet his thrusts.

Tony complied, banging even harder until he let out a grunt through clenched teeth. His buttocks clenched and relaxed several times, which told the watching men that Tony was adding his own brand of cream to the pot. He gave a couple more thrusts then pulled out, breathing heavily.

Claudia smiled at him over her shoulder, then looked at the other men. "Number three?"

Pete stepped forward. Claudia bent her elbows and lowered her head down to the mattress but left her bum up in the air. Rather than climbing on

the bed, Pete placed his hands around her thighs and pulled her toward the foot of the bed so he could reach her while standing on the floor. Once she was in position, she wiggled her raised backside invitingly. Pete unfastened his jeans and took out his cock, which was huge.

Scott stared at it. He glanced up at the other men, and their eyes were all fixed on Pete's cock. Even Demi looked surprised by Pete's length and girth.

Pete guided himself into position and, unlike Tony, he eased himself in carefully.

Claudia let out a groan as she stretched around his girth, and her voice rose in pitch as Pete fed her inch after inch. "Oh... My... *Fuck!*"

It seemed to take about ten seconds for his full length to disappear inside her. As he pulled slowly out, her stretched labia clung to the shaft as if reluctant to let it go. Scott was worried Pete would pull her inside out before he got his chance to fuck her.

As Pete pushed back in, a squelching sound was accompanied by a gloop of cum being squeezed out. Pete paid it no attention and slid all the way back inside. When he pulled back again, the cum formed a rope bridge between Claudia's upper thigh and Pete's balls.

"Fuck me like that," she whispered. "Fuck me slow and deep."

That's exactly what he did, and the others watched with a kind of reverence. Claudia was letting out long wails every time he bottomed out, but her voice was getting higher with each stroke. She'd told them to use her for their pleasure, but it was obvious that she was getting more out of this than she had from the first two.

Claudia turned her head onto one side and looked up at her husband. He held her gaze and offered her a smile. Scott wondered if she needed Demi's permission to enjoy it this much, because she was undoubtedly enjoying this. Her breathing had become ragged, and small tremors ran through her thighs. She was close to orgasm.

Pete maintained the same rhythm. Demi was watching his wife's face, but everyone else had their eyes on the thick shaft—slick and lubricated by the mixture of juices—sliding in and out.

Claudia let out a long exhale and then a mewl. She held her hand out. Demi bent to take it, squeezing it in his huge paw.

Scott got the impression that although Claudia had done this before, she didn't usually come while giving herself to the other men. Could that be the reason for her little speech about not trying to give her pleasure? Maybe she usually just let the guys take turns while Demi watched, then when they were alone he'd make love to her and give her release.

"Yeah, that. Keep doing that." Claudia's voice was a hoarse whisper.

Pete's eyes were closed, concentration creasing his sweat-covered brow. It was probably a struggle for him to keep it in his balls.

As Claudia's moans and squeals announced the arrival of her orgasm, her contractions must have lit the blue touchpaper for Pete. He buried himself as deep as he could go and dropped his head back. Claudia must have felt his cock pulse and twitch because she groaned anew, jerking her hips and pushing herself back onto him.

Pete renewed his thrusts, slamming into her with force and making her scream. She might have come again, or perhaps he'd just poked parts that he hadn't reached earlier. Whatever had happened, she seemed to enjoy it. He eventually stilled, then slowly withdrew. Claudia stayed in the same position, her head on the bed, her bum sticking up in the air. Her back shone with perspiration, and her cunt gaped open. She crawled further onto the bed and rolled onto her back. Her face was bathed in sweat, tendrils of hair clinging to her forehead and cheeks.

She smiled at Demi, then glanced at the men. "Who's number four?"

Scott lifted his hand, then regretted it because it made him feel like he was answering a question in class.

Claudia smiled and beckoned him on top of her. He knelt on the bed and unbuttoned his jeans. His cock was nothing like as big as Pete's, and he worried that she wouldn't even feel it. As she parted her legs, she reached out her hand and guided his cock into her. As he lay down on her soft, warm body, he felt the wet heat of her cunt's grip.

She slid her arms around Scott's waist and pulled him close to whisper into his ear. "Take it slow and gentle for a while."

He nodded and started to move on her, marvelling at how good her body felt beneath him. This was the first time he'd had sex since the split from Janice, and after watching Claudia taking the first three guys, he doubted he'd last very long. He'd had blue balls before this evening started, so God knows what term referred to them now. They felt like a shaken bottle of champagne; all that was needed was to remove the cork.

Claudia undulated beneath him, fucking him from below. Her hands dragged over the back of his shirt, making it stick to the moisture on his skin. "There's no egg to fight over," she whispered.

He raised his head and looked into her eyes, puzzled.

She smiled and placed her hand on the back of his head, pulling him down so she could whisper in his ear. "Your cum doesn't have to fight for the egg, so you don't have to come inside me. You can come wherever you want."

He *wanted* to come inside her, to push in deep and watch her face as he did it, but it seemed Claudia wanted something else. "Where do you want it?"

"Everywhere. My tits, my face. I'll take it in my mouth if you want."

He nodded and started to thrust harder. She moved with him, clenching around him and bringing him to the boil. He gave one final thrust then pulled out and knelt up on the bed. Claudia raised her head and reached for his cock. She opened her mouth and got her lips around the tip just in time. Scott grunted and erupted into her mouth. She yelped and gagged, gulping noisily and bobbing her head. He shot another couple of spurts into her mouth, then pulled out and pushed her back down and re-entered her cunt. She cried out and bucked beneath him. He closed his eyes and pounded her; he wasn't finished yet. He fucked her hard for almost a minute then pulled out and sent a thick cord of cum up onto her tits.

Claudia cried out in surprise and ran her fingers through the mess as he pumped his cock and sent two more splashes onto her stomach, which she rubbed in with her other hand.

When he finally looked up into her face, she gave him a beautiful smile. He climbed off the bed and stood on shaking legs as he tucked his

flaccid, spent cock back into his trousers.

The room was silent for a few seconds, then Claudia looked up at Ben. “How do you want me?”

He shrugged as he yanked open his trousers. “I don’t care, but if you don’t get me inside you soon I’ll blow it in my pants.”

She laughed. “Oh, we don’t want that.” She rolled over onto her front and spread her legs, bending her knees.

Ben crawled onto the bed and positioned himself above her, guiding his cock between her legs. Scott wondered if she wanted him to take her anally, but that obviously wasn’t Ben’s intention. He slid into her from behind and fucked her where the other four had. Holding himself up on straight arms, he pumped his hips. Claudia’s feet bounced in the air in time with his thrusts, then she turned her head to the side and told him to fuck her hard and come on her back.

The Glaswegian did exactly that, lasting a lot longer than he’d said he would before pulling out and spraying spurt after spurt of pearly-white cum over her tanned, sweaty back and arse.

He got up and left the cum-splattered Claudia spread-eagled on the bed. Demi smiled at the other men, then helped his wife to stand up. She pulled on her thong and replaced her dress, not bothering to wipe off the cum beforehand. Then she stepped into her shoes and stood next to her husband.

“Well,” she said, “thank you for a wonderful evening.”

The men gave little chuckles.

“I’m not sure whose bed it was, but there are fresh covers in the top of the closet over there,” she said, pointing. “I may see you at breakfast, but one of the other guides will be taking you out tomorrow.”

This was a shock and a disappointment for Scott, and from the look on the other men’s faces, them too.

She shrugged. “That was always the plan. It’s good for you to get different guides. I’m sure you’ll have a great time with whoever the guide is. I hope you get to see a leopard, because they’re the most beautiful of the Serengeti animals.”

There was an awkward wait for one of the Maasai porters to come and escort Pete and Tony to the next lodge, then Claudia and Demi to wherever the guides slept. After they'd all left, Scott, Alan and Ben all looked at each other in disbelief.

Ben blew out his cheeks. "Well, that was a pleasant surprise."

"You can say that again." Alan dropped onto one of the unused beds. "I still can't believe it happened. Do you think she planned to do it all along?"

The other two shrugged.

"I mean," Alan went on, "she kept going on about the animals' mating habits."

"It was Tony who started those conversations with his alpha obsession," Scott pointed out.

"Aye," Ben laughed. "I wonder how he feels about alphas now he's seen the size of Pete's cock."

The other two laughed and nodded.

"D'you reckon Demi's actually her husband, or just her pimp?"

"I think a pimp would have suggested we paid for what we had," Alan pointed out. "I know there are couples like that—husbands who like to watch their wives with other men."

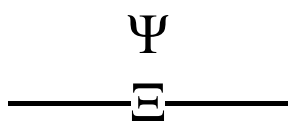
"Aye, well I'm glad he turned up. It was him who brought up lemon sharks."

Scott realised Ben was right. "You think it was Demi's idea for her to take us all?"

"Who knows? I'm just saying there was a big difference in the Claudia we spent the day with to the one who just took us all." Ben smiled. "I don't know about you boys, but it was the perfect end to my day on safari. To me, that's wild life at its best."

Scott smiled. Their evening with Claudia had convinced him that he was totally over Janice. What's more, his trip to Africa would be even more memorable than he'd expected.





Mind Games

Chapter 1

George re-read the email from his boss. He checked the latest inventory, then tracked it back to the previous month's figures. Scratching his head, he tried to make sense of the numbers. Claire was right, there *was* a discrepancy. He scrolled back over the past year, then grabbed a pen and started to write down the figures on a notepad. By the time he'd copied the first few months, a pattern had emerged. Something was definitely wrong.

The phone on his desk trilled, making him jump. He picked up before the second ring.

"George, come to my office." Claire hung up before he'd had the chance to ask for a little longer to go through the figures.

He grabbed his notebook, left his office and headed upstairs.

When he arrived at the managers' suite, Claire's secretary smiled at him. "Hi George. You can go straight in."

He gave the pretty blonde a smile. "Thanks, Tracy."

He knocked once and opened the door. Claire got up from behind her desk and nodded towards the table by the window. "George, take a seat." She walked over to join him, and he couldn't help noticing how good she looked. Her hips were maybe a little wider than they had been ten years ago, but her legs were as good as ever. She'd always worn sexy shoes, even in the days when they were both working on the lower floor. He wondered if she even remembered their drunken grope after one of the Christmas parties before her promotion. He'd sucked her tits and gotten his hand inside her panties in a deserted office.

He cleared his throat. "I've been looking at the fig—"

"Good, I'm sure you'll find and fix the problem." She dropped a file on the table and sat opposite him. "So, how are you keeping?"

Her friendly attitude confused him, and for some reason he felt suddenly defensive. “Fine thanks, but a little troubled by the inconsistency you pointed out in your—”

“Yeah. There must be a logical explanation. I’m confident you’ll sort it out.” She gave him another smile. “How’s Brenda?”

Claire’s mention of his wife unnerved him even more than her dismissive attitude to the discrepancy in the figures. “She’s...” He wasn’t about to tell his boss about his marriage problems. “She’s fine.”

“Good. Anyway, the reason I asked you up here was to tell you about Barry.”

“Oh?” Barry ran the other group in Claire’s section.

Claire’s eyebrows knitted together and she shook her head. “He’s been having a few problems at home.”

I’m not surprised. He’d been fucking the redhead from Accounts for six months. “Oh?”

“Hmm. And now one of his kids has gotten himself into some sort of trouble—the police are involved—and I think it’s all become a little too much for poor Barry. His doctor’s signed him off with stress.”

“Oh dear.” *Serves him right for getting blowjobs in the photocopying room.*

“So I was hoping that you’d be able to take over his responsibilities in the short-term.”

“Take over his...?” George had already been struggling with his own workload before being landed with the inventory problem. Getting to the bottom of that would take up a lot of his time, so how could he possibly take on Barry’s workload as well? “I’m not sure I... How long is he going to be off for?”

“Just a couple of months.”

“A couple of *months*?”

“To start with. I guess it depends on if his son ends up being prosecuted and there’s a court case.” Claire reached across and patted his wrist, flashing a conspiratorial grin. “I’m sure you’ll be able to cope. As I recall, you’ve always been good at doing two things at once.”

George's breath caught in his throat. *Is she referring to me sucking her tits and finger-fucking her?* Maybe she did remember the session in the empty office after all.

"Anyway..." Claire pushed the file across the table. "Have a look at this. The annual reviews are coming up in the next few weeks, so if you could go through Barry's notes on how his team members have performed against the targets and their competencies, that'd be great. I'll look at whatever he's already written up on his hard drive and let you have copies of that, too."

"Right." He shrugged and shook his head. "I'll try and make a start on these tonight—"

"Obviously with it being personal information on staff, you're not allowed to take it offsite in case you lose it."

"Oh yeah, right. Well, I'll maybe stay a bit later and read them here." Brenda wouldn't be happy about that. She'd already accused him of caring more about his job than her.

"Good idea." She pushed her chair back and stood up. "Thanks George, I knew I could count on you."

George carried the file and his notepad to the door. When he looked round, Claire was already tapping her keyboard and staring at the screen on her desk. He left the office, smiled at Tracy and headed back downstairs feeling like he'd just been played.

Once back in his own office, he dropped into his chair and covered his face with his hands. *How the fuck am I going to get through all of this shit?*

He placed the file Claire had given him in a desk drawer, then went back to his notepad and the figures from the inventory. The sooner he got to the bottom of that problem, the sooner he'd be able to look at the file.

Although George pitied his colleague's plight, he felt like the vast majority of it was self-inflicted. Maybe if Barry had spent more time with his kids instead of ploughing Tina from Accounts, there'd be no potential court case hanging over his family.

After three hours going through the inventory, he was no closer to finding the answer. He glanced at his watch. With a resigned sigh, he took

out his mobile. He'd been dreading making this call since his meeting with Claire.

Choosing his wife's number, he pressed the call button. Brenda picked up. "Hi." Her voice was cold and emotionless.

"Hey. I'm sorry, but I've been dropped in it a bit here. One of my colleagues has been signed off sick. I'm going to have to work late tonight so—"

"Oh, George." She sounded disappointed.

"I'm sorry, I'll try not to be too late."

Brenda ended the call without another word.

George stared at his phone screen. The smiling face on the contacts icon looked nothing like the woman who'd glared at him over the breakfast table that morning. He couldn't remember how or when they'd started to drift apart, but now wasn't the time to think about that.

After taking the file from his drawer, he opened it up and quickly read through the contents then sorted them into piles. First he'd concentrate on what he needed to do for Barry's day-to-day stuff, then he'd move onto the reports on the performance of his staff.

It took him an hour to find where Barry was up to in his current work. The guy seemed to be at least four weeks behind in most of the things he should have done.

Probably because he'd been spending so many hours in Tina's flat when everyone thought they were both working from home.

Checking his email, George saw that Claire had sent him several emails, each with file attachments. She'd actually signed her last email with 'Thanks xx.' George wasn't sure why it made him smile; they both knew she was asking more of him than she should, but right now, he didn't care.

When it got to seven he picked up the top sheet from the pile of Barry's team's reviews. He'd decided to read what their targets for the year had been.

"She's certainly shat on you, buddy."

George looked up, startled. He'd been alone in his office for over five hours, yet there was a strange guy sitting on the chair by the wall.

“How did you...?” George’s mouth dropped open. He *did* know this guy. At least, he thought he did.

“Hi George.” The guy gave him a warm smile. “I was worried you wouldn’t remember me.”

Move over Barry, make room for another patient in the nuthouse.
“You’re not here.”

“I know, and yet...” He held his arms out as if to say, ‘Here I am’.

It was Oscar, the now grown-up version of George’s imaginary friend from his troubled childhood.

He’d first appeared to the 12-year-old George during his mum and dad’s contentious divorce. His parents had fought mercilessly for a better settlement, both treating him like a pawn. Neither had seemed to care about the boy as much as they cared about getting the best share of the assets, and George had suffered as a consequence. He became withdrawn and nervous. His schoolwork had suffered to such an extent that his teachers considered making him drop back to repeat the entire year.

Then Oscar had turned up. His cheeky, sarcastic persona had been like a breath of fresh air for the frightened and depressed George. Oscar had pointed out the flaws in each parent’s version of reality as they’d tried to convince George to tell only their side of events. He’d also accompanied George to his regular visits at the child psychologists, often pulling faces and farting when the mood got too sombre.

“Oscar,” George said, getting up from his desk. “Why are you here?”

“You tell me, buddy.”

George took a breath, hesitated, then shook his head. If he’d invented Oscar during the trauma of his childhood, then maybe he was more concerned about his current problems than he realised.

Oscar gave a sad smile. “Looks like there’s another shitstorm brewing on your horizon.”

George smiled, then perched his backside on the desktop and folded his arms. “And you’re going to help me get through it by standing behind Claire and farting?”

Oscar shook his head. “No, I’m going to help you remember how good her big hard nipple felt between your lips, and the breathy little yelps she made when you finger-fucked her happy valley in the empty office.”

“I don’t think that’ll help me get through the workload.” George studied the apparition he’d known so well twenty-odd years earlier. “You’ve not aged well.”

“Fuck off.” Oscar looked offended. “Do you own a mirror? Take a look at yourself.”

George laughed, and he realised it was probably the first time he’d done that in weeks. “You’re going bald.”

“That’s down to my high levels of testosterone. You must have oestrogen because it looks like you’re growing breasts.”

George laughed again. He’d stopped running and going to the gym because there simply weren’t enough hours in the day. “So, are you here to help me, or just to throw out insults?”

Oscar ran a hand over his thinning hair. “You started it.”

Smiling, George decided he needed caffeine. “I’m going to get myself a coffee. Do you want one?”

Oscar put a hand in his trouser pocket as if rummaging for change. When he brought it out, he held up his two fingers and flashed him the V sign.

George laughed and left for the break-out area. When he came back, Oscar was sitting cross-legged reading last year’s performance appraisal on one of Barry’s team.

“This guy’s useless,” Oscar said. “I think you should sack him for impersonating a placebo.”

“I don’t have the authority to terminate anyone’s contract.”

“In that case, put poison in his tea. The guy’s a complete ballbag.”

“Is that your professional opinion?”

Oscar nodded, shuffled the sheet to the bottom of the pile and looked at the next one. “This guy Dan is better. Seems to have a good understanding of what needs to be done. Promote this one and fire the other cunt.” Oscar shuffled through to the next sheet. “This one’s average. Give

him a cost-of-living rise and tell him to try harder next year.” He got up, walked across the office and put the papers back on the desk. “There you go. Now I’ve sorted that out for you, let’s go home and face the Ice Queen.”

George closed his eyes and sighed. He’d forgotten what hard work Oscar could be.

* * * *

Oscar complained about George’s driving all the way home, which reminded George about the time he’d fallen off his bike with Oscar on the crossbar. For someone who wasn’t real, Oscar seemed to have an exceptionally low fear threshold.

George found a parking spot on the road about twenty yards from their home. The house was in darkness when he opened the front door. A note from Brenda was sitting on the table in the hall. She’d gone for supper at Vicky’s. She expected to be back later, but if they decided to have a few glasses of wine she’d stay the night.

Oscar read the note over George’s shoulder. “Maybe Vicky is short for Victor, and they’re having *cock au vin* with the malbec.”

“No, Vicky’s a woman. I’ve met her.”

Oscar grinned. “Even better. They’re probably already on the fish course.”

“You’re sick.” George took his jacket off and went through to the kitchen. He took two beers from the fridge and held the bottles up to Oscar. “This is something I didn’t know about when you last showed up.”

Oscar smiled. “Maybe that’s what’s given you tits.”

“Or it could be what stops my hair falling out.” George found the bottle opener, removed the caps and walked into the living room. He placed one bottle on the coffee table and sat in his usual armchair. Oscar took the couch.

Glancing around the room, Oscar frowned. “I thought you’d have had a bigger house by now.”

“I like this house.”

“You might not feel the same if you suffered from claustrophobia.”

George sipped his beer. Brenda wanted a bigger house, with a garden where they could sit out, and a driveway where they could park their cars.

“I suppose if there were kids,” Oscar said, “then you’d *have* to buy a bigger house.”

Narrowing his eyes, George stared at his imaginary friend. He and Brenda had now accepted that having a family wasn’t going to happen, so Oscar’s appearance was nothing to do with that particular trauma. “We don’t need a family. Besides, what would I know about being a parent? Mine were hardly role models.”

“How are they doing?”

“Dad married his secretary. She left him and cleaned him out of everything he’d managed to keep after his first divorce. Mum moved to Spain over ten years ago. I don’t see either of them now, an arrangement that suits us all.”

Oscar gave a sad shake of the head. “What about the Ice Queen? What’s gone wrong there?”

George finished his beer and snorted. “How long have you got?”

“I’m guessing she’ll be carpet munching for another few hours.”

George laughed. “Vicky’s in her sixties. If Brenda ever has a lesbian fling, I’m pretty sure it won’t be with a woman twice her age.”

“She married you, fat boy.”

“Ha ha.”

Oscar crossed his legs and folded his hands on his knee. “You could have fucked Claire, you know.”

“What?”

“In that dark office after the Christmas party. She was desperate for your cock.”

“No she wasn’t.”

Oscar nodded. “She was hot to trot, but you didn’t give her what she wanted.”

“It wouldn’t have been right. I was engaged to Brenda at the time.”

“Then you shouldn’t have been sucking her tits and pressing her bellybutton from the inside.”

“I know.” Although he’d surprised himself with his restraint, not fucking Claire that evening was one of the biggest regrets of his life.

“Do you think the Ice Queen has found an alternative source of sausage meat?”

Despite the disparaging way his wife was being referred to, George chuckled. “No, I don’t.”

“That’s what your mum thought when your dad was employing his special kind of dictation on the secretary.”

George went to get two more beers. He returned to the small living room and plonked one bottle on the coffee table, dropped back into his armchair and took a large slug from the other. “Brenda’s not like that.”

“If you say so.”

George closed his eyes and thought about the growing rift between him and his wife. She had a low-paying job at the museum that she loved; he had a well-paid job in middle management that he hated. She was home at five-thirty every night, but he often worked late and needed to do extra paperwork once he got home. He had a low sperm-count and she suffered from polycystic ovary syndrome. Conception wasn’t impossible, just very unlikely. Having a family would be more straightforward if either of them had chosen a different partner.

Letting out a long sigh, he got up and went for two more beers. Then he closed his eyes again and drank as he thought about the discrepancy in the figures he’d been working on earlier.

A hand shook his shoulder. He grumbled at Oscar without opening his eyes.

“George!” It was Brenda’s voice.

He sat up quickly, spilling the remnants of the beer in the bottle he was still clutching. “Fuck,” he said, wiping his trousers.

“Are you drunk?” Brenda asked.

“No, of course not.” He glanced at the five empty bottles on the coffee table and the one in his hand. “I thought you were staying over at

Vicky's."

"So you thought you'd get pissed and sleep in the chair?"

"No, I..." He looked over at Oscar, who was fast asleep on the couch with his head propped up on one end and his feet on the other. "I'm sorry. Barry's been signed off with stress and I've been asked to take on his work for a while."

Brenda scoffed. "How can you do that? You're already working twice as many hours as you should."

"I know. Hopefully it won't be for long."

"Well, I'm going to bed. You can sleep here if you like."

Brenda walked upstairs, and George duly followed. While she visited the bathroom, he put on his pyjamas. By the time he'd taken a pee and brushed his teeth, Brenda was in bed. Her lamp was already off and she lay with her back to him.

He climbed into bed, turned off his own lamp and fell asleep.

Chapter 2

George woke alone in bed. He walked through to the bathroom, had a pee and went downstairs. Brenda was already dressed, sitting on the couch in the living room watching breakfast TV while eating a toasted bagel.

“Morning,” he said.

She scowled at him. “If I’d known you were going to snore all night, I’d have left you in the armchair.”

Oscar smiled from the other end of the couch. “Maybe now’s not the time to ask for a blowjob.”

George ignored him and went through to the kitchen to make himself coffee and cereal.

Brenda came through to put her plate in the sink, then went upstairs. Two minutes later she returned with her coat on. “Right, I’m going to work. I’ll see you whenever.” She’d closed the front door behind her before he’d thought of anything to say in his defence.

“Don’t sleep on your back when you’ve drunk six beers,” Oscar intoned.

George went upstairs, brushed his teeth, showered, shaved and got dressed. He was halfway to work before Oscar pointed out that his trousers smelled of stale beer. With a sigh, he decided it wouldn’t matter because he was going to be doing two people’s work alone in his office all day long.

After they’d arrived at the business park, he and Oscar bickered about the state of his marriage all the way from the car park to his office. George moved to the table by the window and started to work on the figures while Oscar spun himself around in George’s desk chair. By eleven o’clock he had scribbled out all of the figures from the previous year’s inventory on several sheets of paper and had them spread out on the table. Of the last twelve months, only three had figures that were wrong: July, December and April. George stared at the figures and tapped his pen against his teeth.

Oscar finally got off the spinning chair and came up to stand next to him, looking down at the sheets of numbers. “Worked it out yet, genius?”

George shook his head. “Why would those three be wrong when all the others are okay? If it’s a problem with the way things are calculated, it should be consistently wrong every month. What’s special about July, December and April?”

Oscar grinned. “Were they the last three occasions you got lucky with the Ice Queen?”

George ignored him.

“*A-ha*. That’s it!” Oscar clapped his hands and gave a bright smile. “Problem solved.”

“What are you going on about?”

“I’ve just sorted out your next problem. Yesterday I told you what to do with Mad Barry’s crew, and now I’ve worked out why the figures are wrong. All I need to sort out now is your frigid wife and your diet.”

“I haven’t got a clue what you’re talking about.” George rustled the sheets of paper on the table. “You haven’t helped me with these *or* Barry’s team. I can’t sack one, promote another and tell the third to try harder next year. That’s not how we do things.”

Oscar shrugged. “Suit yourself, fatty.”

Just then, a knock on the door made George turn around and Tina walked into his office. She wore a white silk blouse and hip-hugging black skirt with black high heels and nylons.

“Hi George,” she said.

“Tina... Hi.” George moved behind his desk to try and hide his stained trousers. He gave her a smile. “What can I do for you?”

“I know what *I’d* do for her,” Oscar said.

“I was wondering if...” She turned around and stepped back to close the door to prevent anyone overhearing. There were tears in her emerald-green eyes, and she looked worried. “Have you heard from Barry at all?”

“Er, no, sorry. I’ve been told he’s going to be off for a couple—”

“I’ve tried texting him, but he’s blocked my number.”

“Oh.” Barry’s wife obviously knew about the affair. “I’m sorry.”

“I’d heard that you’re covering his work for him...”

“If she asks you to fill in with the shagging,” Oscar said, looking her up and down from behind, “say ‘yes’ for fuck’s sake.”

George waited.

“I was just wondering...” Tina stepped a little closer to his desk. “Are you in contact with him regarding work issues?”

“No.” He stared at her shiny red lips, trying not to think about Barry sliding his cock between them. “I’ve been told he’s not to be disturbed.” It was a lie. “Apparently his son’s in some sort of trouble with the pol—”

“That fucking little crackhead. I hope he gets...” Tina closed her eyes and shook her head. “Sorry, I just... It doesn’t matter.” She gave a sad smile. “If you do hear from Barry, please tell him I was asking after him.”

“Yeah, sure.”

As Tina made her way to the office door, Oscar glared at George. “Don’t let her leave. Ask her if she needs anything. Tell her you’re free any lunchtime this week or next. Offer to meet her in the photocopying room.”

George watched Tina walk out of his office, then continued watching her down the corridor until she turned the corner at the end.

“What a fucking babe,” Oscar said.

George couldn’t disagree.

“I’m not surprised Barry’s stressed,” Oscar said. “Losing the chance to fuck her every lunchtime would drive anyone crazy.”

George nodded. Barry had been the envy of most of the men on this floor. With a sigh, he dropped into his chair and decided to try and catch up with his own team’s performance reviews, and then make a start on the work Barry should have done for the last month.

At eleven he went into the break-out area and got himself a coffee. A couple of secretaries were chatting as they cut up a large chocolate cake. George stared at it until they noticed him.

“Libby brought it in,” one of them explained. “It’s her birthday. Would you like a piece?”

“Yeah, that’d be great,” he said, trying to remember who Libby was.

The secretary cut him a large slice and placed it on a tissue. “There you go.”

“Thanks, and please thank Libby for me.” George returned to his office and placed the cake on the desk, smiling.

“Still eating healthily, I see,” Oscar said.

“Yeah,” George said sarcastically. “My body is a temple.”

“Looks more like a bouncy castle.”

George laughed as he dropped into his chair and picked up the cake. “Well, I could diet and exercise to help me lose weight, but I guess you’re just going to have to buy a wig.”

“Very droll.”

“Thanks. Now shut the fuck up and let me do some work.”

Oscar tutted. “What you should be working on is a plan to get some of what Barry was getting.”

“Why would I do that? It didn’t seem to do him much good.”

“*What?*” Oscar looked incredulous. “He was fucking the hottest woman in the building. He was dumping his load down her throat while you and your colleagues chatted round the water cooler.”

“I don’t think—”

“And God alone knows what he was getting up to while you were all working from home. I bet you and the Ice Queen hardly spoke to each other all day. Barry, on the other hand, was most likely playing hide the sausage every hour.”

“You’re sick.”

“Yeah, sick of you not having a sex life.”

“I have a sex life.”

“Bollocks. Barry probably had more fun in a single day with Tina than you’ve had all year with the Frosty One.”

“You don’t know what Barry got.”

Oscar shrugged. “Maybe not, but I know what *you’re* not getting. And I’ve seen Tina. Can you imagine what it’d be like to slide your cock into her, to feel that body moving under you? Think about lying on your back with her impaled on your meat, those big green eyes watching your face as she brings you to the boil...”

George wiped the chocolate from his fingers and opened up the shared drive on his computer. “Just let me get on with—”

“D’you reckon she takes it up the arse?”

George looked up, his fingers hovering over the keyboard. “What?”

“Tina. I mean, she’s got a killer body and a gorgeous face, but that’s not all she’s got. She exudes something else, something... She’s like a walking wank-fest.” Oscar closed his eyes and shook his head. “I’m not going to lie. I’d happily trade places with Barry. A few months in the nuthouse is a small price to pay for six months bouncing on her.”

“He’s not in the nuthouse. He’s staying at home with his wife.”

“I bet she’s nothing like Tina.”

George had met Barry’s wife several times. “No, she isn’t. But they have a child who needs them.”

“It sounds like he needs a slap. Tina called him a crackhead.” Oscar grinned. “I wouldn’t mind getting my head up her crack.”

George tried to drown out Oscar’s voice as he worked through his team’s achievements over the past twelve months. He knew that they’d all achieved their targets and was grateful for their efforts.

Oscar was mumbling something about having sex with Tina’s cleavage when the office door opened and Claire walked in. George’s heartbeat raced. His boss hadn’t visited his office for years; when she needed to talk to him, he was summoned upstairs.

He noticed her shoes immediately, and even though he knew it was rude to stare, he couldn’t tear his eyes away from them. Red leather, opened-toed with a four-inch stiletto heel and ankle strap; they were incredibly sexy and completely inappropriate for work.

“George?”

He looked up and saw her amused expression. “Sorry, I was... I couldn’t help admiring your shoes.”

“Thank you. I’m going to lunch with a couple of the directors and thought I’d better make an effort.” She frowned. “You have chocolate on your face.”

George roughly wiped round his mouth. Claire smiled, leaned over his desk and used her finger to wipe the remaining chocolate icing from the tip of his nose.

“It’s Libby’s birthday,” he explained. “She’s made a cake.”

“Hmm.” She frowned again, then stepped back and looked around the office. Oscar made a ring with his left thumb and forefinger, and repeatedly poked in and out of it with the middle finger of his right hand.

Thank fuck Claire can’t see him. “Was there something you need to see me about?” George asked.

“I was down on this floor anyway, and thought I’d call to see how you were getting on with—”

“Fine.” George nodded repeatedly, though he really hadn’t a clue why he felt the need to lie. “I’ve had a look at where Barry was up to and started to catch up. I’ve also looked at his team’s work over the past year.”

“Great, thanks George.”

Oscar was now reclining on his chair by the wall with his legs open and eyes closed, doing a commendable impression of the yelping noises Claire made while George had finger-fucked her all those years ago.

George struggled to ignore him. “Was there anything else?”

She shook her head, then smiled at him. “I really appreciate your help with this. It’s come to my attention that Barry’s been doing a little extracurricular work with a certain member of the accounting team.”

“Yeah, I’d heard something similar.”

She took her lower lip between her teeth for a couple of seconds, then smiled wickedly. “Well, I guess we can’t condemn him, given what we got up to in the office just down that corridor.”

George’s mouth dropped open.

She laughed. “Don’t look so shocked. I still think about it.”

“Me too.”

She gave him a lovely smile. “It’s probably for the best that we didn’t go any further.”

George shook his head. “I’m not sure I agree.”

“Me neither.” She stood up straight. “Right, stop flirting. I need to go and act like a responsible manager for the directors.”

“I’m sure you’ll fool them.”

She gave him a mock-sowl and left his office.

Oscar was smirking. “You could still fuck her.”

“No I couldn’t.”

“No, you’re right. Since that day in the office, she’s added fifty thousand pounds to her salary and you’ve added almost as many around your waist.”

“Right, I’ve got lots of work to do. Maybe before I start, we could play a little game.”

Oscar smiled. “Okay.”

“Good. It’s called *Fuck Off*. You go first.”

Oscar sighed and got up. “You should leave the funny lines to thin people.”

“Yeah yeah. Keep your hair on—oh, wait a minute...” He grinned.

“I’ll go for a walk around the Accounts office. Can I take a tissue? I suspect the view might make me weep.”

“You’re a sick bastard.”

“Pardon?” came a voice from the corridor.

George looked up, his eyes wide. Claire had left the door open and one of the guys from the neighbouring office had been walking past. “Sorry Matt, I was talking to my buddy on the phone.”

“Right.” Matt frowned, glanced at George’s blank-screened mobile on his desk, then walked off down the corridor.

George closed his eyes and counted to ten. When he opened them again, Oscar had disappeared.

The chocolate cake had made him feel sick, so he didn’t bother with lunch. He spent five hours writing up his own team’s performance reviews, making recommendations for them all to get rewarded. Next he did a similar thing with Barry’s team, though he didn’t make recommendations, just offered his own brief thoughts. Before starting on Barry’s own work, he

emailed the data-entry group leader to ask who was responsible for collating the figures George got sent every month.

By the time he looked at his watch it was almost six. Traffic was a nightmare at this time of evening, so he probably wouldn't get home until after seven. He decided to phone Brenda to let her know.

"Hi, it's me."

"I hope you're phoning to say you can't find a parking space outside our house."

"No, I'm phoning to say I'm just about to leave the office."

He heard her sigh. "Fine," she said. "I'll eat now. Maybe you can call and get yourself a takeaway."

"That'll be—"

She'd already ended the call.

With a sigh, George closed down his computer, locked the personal files in his desk drawer and turned off his office lights. As he made his way out of the building, he saw Oscar sitting in the deserted reception foyer.

"Tina's just left," he announced. "She was with a guy from her own department. Women like that don't stay lonely for long. You've missed your chance."

George headed out to the car park and started to whistle in order to drown out Oscar's voice.

"Like you missed your chance with Claire all those years ago."

He whistled louder.

"Just like you're missing the chance of a normal sex life by staying faithful to the Ice Queen."

George got in his car and drove as recklessly as he could all the way home, smiling at the fear on Oscar's face. He didn't bother calling for a takeaway, deciding instead to make himself a toasted bagel with cream cheese.

When he arrived home, the lights were on and Brenda had scrawled 'Having a bath' on the blackboard in the kitchen. He went upstairs to change, letting his wife know that he was home. Back in the kitchen, he put two bagels in the toaster and took the cream cheese from the fridge.

Oscar watched wide-eyed as George made himself a relatively healthy meal. “Is this the start of a new fitness regime?”

George shrugged. “Maybe.” He looked at Oscar’s receding hairline. “I think there’s a procedure now where they can transplant your pubes to your forehead, which would be quite appropriate for a dickhead like you.”

Oscar sighed. “Ah, the humour never stops.”

George carried his bagel through to the living room and dropped into his armchair.

Oscar sat on the couch. “Not having a low-cal smoothie with your snack?”

George ignored him, flicked on the TV and watched the news channel. After two minutes he was so depressed he turned it off again.

Once he’d finished his bagels he made himself a cup of tea, which Oscar smirked at but didn’t comment on.

Brenda came downstairs after her bath and sat on the couch next to Oscar. Her shoulder-length hair was still wet, and she wore a fluffy white robe. George saw she’d applied dark red nail varnish to her toes. He couldn’t remember the last time he’d seen her wear nail varnish. When she crossed her legs, they looked smooth and freshly shaved. There was a sheen to them, presumably from some cream or oil she’d applied after drying herself.

“How’s it going at work?” she asked, though she didn’t actually seem to be interested.

“I’m getting there.” He decided to tell her the truth, even though he usually avoided gossip in case she assumed he was up to something as well. “It turns out Barry’s not been keeping up with his work because he’s been seeing a woman from another department on the sly.”

“Lucky him.”

George almost dropped his cup at her very un-Brenda-like response.

She smiled. “I’m kidding. Is that why he’s been signed off with stress?”

“It might play some part if his wife’s found out, but his son’s in some sort of trouble with the police. It’s possibly drug-related, but that’s

just hearsay.”

“So they’ve called in Sir George, their knight in shining armour, to help get them out of the mire.”

He smiled. “That’s not quite how they phrased it.”

“No, I don’t suppose it was.” She frowned at the TV, then shook her head. “I’m going to go and read in bed for a while and then have an early night. I didn’t get much sleep last night.”

“Sorry about the snoring.” He pointed at his teacup. “This is decaf.”

Brenda got up and left the room.

George sat in silence until he heard the bedroom door close, then turned to Oscar. “Did you notice anything unusual?”

“She looked good.”

“Good?”

“All smooth and soft. And her feet looked sexy.”

“Yeah, that’s what I thought.”

“She’s fucking around.”

“No she—”

“Why else would she be shaving her legs and painting her toes on a school night? She’s found someone else to satisfy her needs, so you should concentrate on getting back into Claire’s knickers or keeping Tina company during her lonely lunch hours.” He bobbed his eyebrows. “Or both.”

“Neither of them is going to happen.”

“Suit yourself. I’m only trying to help.”

“I find that hard to believe.”

Oscar leaned back on the couch and drew thumb and finger across his mouth as if zipping his lips.

George closed his eyes and thought about why his subconscious had felt the need to conjure up an imaginary friend during his troubled childhood. He’d been in a bad place, but Oscar had shown him a way out of it. Through a combination of childish pranks at the psychologist’s, sarcastic commentary during his parents’ arguments, and late-night banter to help him stop crying, George knew he had a lot to thank his friend for. His dad’s sister Jenny—the only relative he actually liked—had once said George was

the only one to make it through the divorce with all his marbles, and that he'd shown the most maturity during the entire debacle.

George knew that had all been down to Oscar's help. What worried him now was that Oscar might be showing him that his own marriage was in danger of following the same route. He hoped that wasn't the case.

Chapter 3

George didn't sleep well, and when he woke at 6:30 he decided to go into the office early. He showered but didn't bother to shave because his electric razor would wake Brenda; she didn't work on Thursdays.

Oscar watched with an amused grin as George ate muesli for breakfast, then they drove in relative silence to work. He was at his desk before seven-thirty and booted up his computer. He quickly caught up with the work Barry should have done over the previous month, and then decided to arrange for Dan, the most efficient member of Barry's team, to do some of the day-to-day things in his boss's absence. *Delegation is the key to success.*

The data-entry lady had answered his query, and George scratched his head. He sent a follow-up email, then went to get himself a coffee. Resisting the urge for a chocolate bar, he returned to his office and spent the next couple of hours doing his own work.

Oscar was sitting on the table by the window staring over the car park. "I haven't seen Tina come in yet."

"Oh dear. I don't know how you'll cope."

"She probably spent the entire night getting nailed by the guy she left with. Barry will be a distant memory to her by now. She'll have had the new guy's joy-juice pumped into every hole."

"Yeah, probably."

"It could have been yours."

"I don't want his joy-juice in my hole."

Oscar scoffed. "I'd have thought you'd be up for anything, given how long it's been since you had any fun. The Ice Queen's new guy probably had to dust the cobwebs off her twat before he could slide her his pipe."

George spun his chair round and glared at him. "And what the fuck would you know about—?"

"George?" It was Claire's voice. "George, are you okay?"

George turned to look at her, his mouth agape. “Claire! Hi. Yeah, I was just...” He waved his hand in front of his face while he tried to think of a rational explanation for shouting at the table in his office.

“George, I think that I’ve been asking too much from—”

“I’m fine. I—”

“You’re unshaven.”

He ran his hand through the stubble on his chin. “Yeah, I was going for the George Michael look.”

“He’s dead. And yesterday you stank like a pub carpet.”

He giggled, then realised how stupid it sounded and abruptly stopped. “I spilled a beer on my trousers the night before, then forgot to get a clean pair from—”

“And you were shouting obscenities at someone from the Pensions Department.”

He shook his head. “That was a misunderstanding.” He grinned manically. “I thought it was Barry.”

Claire frowned. “There’s also security footage of you apparently arguing with yourself walking across the car park yesterday morning.”

George took a breath, held it, and then sighed. “I was on my phone. Hands free, and I—”

“I’m so sorry, George. I’ve put too much on your plate, and the last thing I need is to lose another group leader to stress.”

“That’s not...” He shook his head far too vigorously; he probably looked like he was having some sort of seizure. “I’m not—”

“Go home.”

“What?”

“Forget about work. Go home and spend the day relaxing. Drink tequila shots, watch porn and eat popcorn. Get a good rest, then come back when you feel up to it.”

“Claire, I’m okay. Really, I just...” He smiled, remembering how great she’d looked with her tits out and her skirt up around her waist, those fabulous long legs spread wide. “I don’t want to let you down.”

She walked around his desk to stand next to his chair. “You haven’t, and I’m sure after a short break you’ll be back. We need you.” She bent and kissed his cheek. “*I* need you. But I need you to be the dependable George I’ve known for all these years.”

Tears filled his eyes and a lump appeared in his throat. He nodded. Claire squeezed his hand, smiled, and turned toward the door.

Oscar watched her backside and legs as she walked out, then turned to George with a grin. “She is *so* up for a shagging.”

George glared at him, then closed down his computer and locked his office door with Oscar still sitting on the table. He walked slowly through the building, out onto the car park and to his car. He drove home enjoying the silence and found a parking space on the road next to Brenda’s car because all their neighbours were at work. Their house was so small that the front door opened directly into the living room. There was no sign of his wife in the living room or kitchen so he headed upstairs, thinking maybe she was in the bathroom. She wasn’t expecting him home, and he didn’t want to give her a fright.

When he got to the fourth stair he heard Brenda moan. She was in the bedroom, and he hadn’t heard those sorts of noises from her in a long time. Thoughts from the previous night filled his head; the shaved legs, the painted toenails, and Oscar’s crude explanation. George’s heart ached, and he considered turning round and leaving her to it. Then Brenda let out another moan, and he knew he had to confront her. He crept up the remaining stairs, along the short landing and slowly pushed open the bedroom door.

Brenda was sitting up, riding her lover. The quilt covered their lower bodies, but he could see her jerking her hips forwards and back as she groaned and screamed through what was evidently a very satisfying orgasm.

George cleared his throat, and Brenda snapped her head around to look at him. Her eyes went wide with shock. George glanced at the man beneath her.

Oscar smiled back at him, his hair dishevelled and chest bare. “Looks like she’s not as frigid as we’d assumed, buddy.”

George opened his mouth, but words failed him. He glanced back at his wife's mortified expression, then turned and left the bedroom. On the landing he stopped. His heart hammered in his chest and mind was in turmoil as thoughts tumbled over each other.

Oscar doesn't exist.

It was impossible for him to be in bed with Brenda. It had to be someone else. Perhaps seeing Oscar instead was some sort of self-preservation thing — maybe his subconscious was protecting him from the reality of whoever was really having an affair with his wife.

He went back into the bedroom. Brenda was still sitting on the bed, the quilt now pushed back off her body. She was naked except for a black bra, her head lowered and her hands covering her face. Oscar was nowhere to be seen. On the sheet in front of her was a pink latex vibrator, slick and shiny with her juices.

Brenda looked up at her husband and gave an embarrassed shrug. "You never touch me anymore."

"I..." He frowned and shook his head. "I thought you didn't *want* me to touch you."

"You're never here. Even when you are here, you're always working."

George ran his hand through his hair, relief and guilt fighting for purchase in his mind. "I'm sorry. Things have been getting out of hand at work for a few months, and now with all Barry's stuff as well, it's getting..." He gave a helpless sigh.

"You've been so distant lately, I wondered if you'd been doing the same thing as Barry has."

"*What?* No." He shook his head and smiled. "Of course I haven't, but I thought maybe you'd found someone else. Last night I noticed you'd shaved your legs and painted your toe—"

"Is that why you're home?" she asked accusingly. "Did you sneak back to try and catch me with—?"

"No!" George shook his head again. "No, I've been..." He closed his eyes and tried to calm his nerves. "They've sent me home. Apparently I've been acting a bit weird."

Her expression became one of concern. “What do you mean? How have you been acting weird?”

“Talking to myself. Swearing at people who pass my office.” He laughed. “Going to work in beer-stained trousers and not shaving.”

“Do they think you’re going the same way as Barry?”

“What, getting blowjobs in the photocopying room?”

Brenda’s eyes widened. “Is that what he did?”

“Allegedly.”

“Wow.” She seemed to think about it. “I’d have thought that would de-stress him.”

“Yeah, it probably did—but only until his wife found out about it.”

She smiled, then turned serious again. “But they must be worried about you if they’ve sent you home. Do you feel stressed?”

He was about to deny it, but then acknowledged that things were a little busier than he’d like.

Brenda beckoned him closer and, as he stepped next to the bed, she crawled on her knees to the edge of the mattress. “I don’t want you to do a Barry.”

“I’ll stay away from the photocopier.”

She laughed, then held his gaze. Her cheeks were still pink from her orgasm. George thought it made her look sexy, though the fact she was naked except for a black bra might have had something to do with that.

“So,” she said, reaching up and unbuckling George’s belt. “Barry’s been getting blowjobs at work, and now you’re having to work twice as hard?”

He nodded, hardly daring to breathe as she slipped her hand inside his trousers. They hadn’t had sex in weeks, possibly months. She hadn’t performed oral sex on him in at least five years. As her hand wrapped around his cock, he trembled.

She pulled it out and studied it. George felt himself growing harder by the second. Brenda moved closer and licked her lips. Then she looked up and stared into his eyes as she parted her lips and took him into her mouth.

He let out a long, shuddering breath. Holding his gaze, she began to rock herself forward and back so his cock slid in and out of her mouth. It felt better than wonderful. He slid his jacket off and let it drop to the floor. Brenda pulled his trousers down to his knees as he undid his shirt, and all the time she kept bobbing her head on his cock. She couldn't pull his boxers down because she'd fished his dick out through the hole in the front of them.

When George dropped his shirt on top of his jacket, she released him from her mouth and told him to strip naked and lie on the bed. He complied in less than ten seconds. Brenda immediately straddled him, gripped his cock and positioned herself above it. Watching his face, she slowly lowered herself onto it. She was still wet from her orgasm.

Unless it's Oscar's cum.

George dismissed the irrational idea immediately. He groaned and reached up to stroke her breasts through the bra.

"D'you want me to take it off?" she asked.

"No, I like it." He smiled. "It's sexy."

She gave him a sad smile. "I didn't think you found anything about me sexy nowadays."

George felt another wave of guilt flush through him. All the while he'd thought she was being cold when she was just desperate for attention.

Brenda raised herself off him, scooted down the bed and took his cock back in her mouth. He cried out as she sucked and bobbed her head while pumping the base with her hand. George couldn't remember her ever sucking his cock after it'd been inside her. This was like a dream, and he wondered if he actually *had* lost his mind.

She released him, moved up and quickly impaled herself again. When George looked up, he stared up in shock. The woman on top of him wasn't his wife. He was being ridden by Tina, her boobs straining against the material of the bra.

She bent over him and looked down into his eyes, her red hair hanging either side of his face. "I knew I'd get you in the end." She clenched around him and rocked her hips. "And your cock's so much bigger than Barry's."

He blinked, but it was still Tina. She bounced on him and rotated her hips in the most sensual way, then raised off and slid down his body. When she took his cock deep into her throat, George cried out in a mixture of surprise and wonder. There was no way Brenda could be doing this.

He looked down at the tangle of red hair over his groin, then placed his hand on the back of her head and thrust up from below, fucking her face. Closing his eyes, he revelled in what was happening, even though part of his brain knew he must be hallucinating. Maybe he'd fainted on the landing after seeing her in bed with Oscar.

She slid up his body and resumed fucking him. To George's amazement, when he reopened his eyes she'd turned into Claire, and she was making exactly the same noises as she had ten years earlier in the office chair.

She gave him a sexy smile. "So, where are you going to do it?" she asked, watching his face.

"Sorry?"

"Where do you want to come?" She dragged a nail down his chest. "I can tell from your expression that I won't have to wait much longer."

Considering all he'd been doing was lying on his back, George was extremely breathless. He shook his head. "I don't know."

"Hmm, let's see." Claire dismounted and slid down again.

As soon as her mouth enveloped his cock, George knew the answer. His eyes squeezed shut and his legs locked straight. As she bobbed her head and pumped the base with her hand, he arched off the bed and exploded into her mouth.

She yelped but kept pumping her hand and gulping as George fired more spurts into the hot, wet heaven of her mouth.

Eventually the spasms stopped shaking his body. She kept his cock in her mouth until it became flaccid, then released it and placed gentle kisses on the tip. Finally, she crawled up the bed and snuggled into the crook of his arm.

Almost afraid to look, George opened his eyes to see Brenda smiling up at him. "Did that really happen?" he asked. "Or am I actually in cloud cuckoo land with Barry?"

She laughed. "Does it matter?"

"Not really. I don't mind being crazy if I get sex like that."

Brenda sighed. "I'm sorry for not being..." Tears appeared in her eyes.

George pulled her close and hugged her. "I need to get a better work-life balance. I know that, and I will. I promise."

She shook her head. "You have a responsible job, and I understand that. It's just that sometimes I get... I feel so lonely." She sighed and squeezed her eyes shut, then looked up at him with a creased brow. "But now I feel bad because you're so stressed with work and all I can do is sulk and pile more pressure on you."

George squeezed her in his arms, crushing her body to his.

"I should have been more supportive," she whispered.

"It's not your fault I've had Barry's stuff dropped on me."

"No, but I know you have a lot on your plate at this time of year when you have to sort out everyone's pay rises and stuff. I just..." She sighed again. "I'm sorry for behaving like a bitch."

"You haven't been a bitch. You've just been a bit..."

She raised her eyebrows. "Distant?"

"I was going to say frosty."

"I suppose I have." She looked down, then back into his eyes. "Does the blowjob make up for it?"

"Oh yeah." In truth, he still found it hard to believe what he'd experienced had been performed by Brenda. It was far easier to imagine it had been Tina and Claire. Maybe seeing the other women had been the ultimate mind game, a way of satisfying Oscar's desire.

Brenda kissed his cheek, breaking into his thoughts. "Well, we have all day." She ran her hand across his chest. "When you get your energy back, I'll give you something else."

George felt his balls tingle with excitement. "It's been a long time since we spent all day in bed."

"Too long."

He glanced to the edge of the mattress where her vibrator still lay. “I had no idea you owned a sex toy.”

“I was frustrated. You’re not the only one with a colleague who’s been getting a lot of sex.”

“Oh?”

She nodded. “Vicky has an admirer.”

“Really?”

She nodded. “A retired army major who occasionally gives talks at the museum.”

He grinned. “Does she make certain parts of him stand to attention?”

“I imagine so, though she may have to give him blue pills to make it happen. He’s in his seventies.” She reached down and stroked his still-flaccid cock. “I could do with *this* standing to attention soon.”

“Give me a break. You’ve just drained a couple of months’ worth of protein from me.”

“Well I might not need to eat for hours, but if you can’t get it up, I guess you’re going to have to do some eating yourself.” Brenda straddled his waist and then began to knee-crawl her way further up his body.

George couldn’t believe how she was acting, but he certainly wasn’t going to complain. His wife hadn’t shown this much enthusiasm for sex since they were newlyweds. As she placed her knees on either side of his head, he gripped her hips and pulled her down onto his face, inhaling her musk. When he flicked his tongue through her slick folds, she groaned. He pushed his tongue as far into her channel as he could, and she pushed down to grind on his face. It was a struggle to breathe, but he didn’t care. He fucked her with his tongue, swallowing the juices that entered his mouth. After a minute or so he raised her slightly so he could get to her clit. As soon as he took the engorged bud between his lips, her moans increased and her hip thrusts became more urgent. Sucking gently, he slid his hands around and gripped the cheeks of her backside. Then he pulled her onto his mouth and brushed his tongue over and around her clit.

Brenda screamed, and he felt a trickle of her juices on his chin. He kept sucking, and she kept screaming. Then he released her clit and pushed

his tongue back inside her. She rode his face, making his eyes water as her pubic bone squashed his nose.

He was now hard again so he pushed her off and rolled her onto her back, dragging her down the bed. She spread her legs and started scratching at his shoulders before he'd even managed to get inside her. As soon as his cock slid into her hot sheath, she dragged her fingernails down his back. George ran his hands all over her body, rubbing at her arse cheeks, hips and thighs. Then he pushed her bra up so he could grope her tits. He rolled her nipples between his fingers and thumbs as he and Brenda writhed together in a frenzied tangle of grappling limbs and hungry mouths.

He remembered how good the sex had been in their early days, but he was certain this was better. There was more desire. More hunger. As they thrashed and bucked on the bed, a desperate need seemed to be seeping from their pores along with the sweat. Brenda raised her head and bit into his shoulder, and at the same moment the clench of her orgasm sent him over the edge. He cried out and erupted inside her, and they grunted and jerked through their orgasms before collapsing in a heap on the twisted sheet.

George rolled onto his back and sucked in huge gasps of air. He glanced around the bedroom, but there was no sign of Oscar.

Brenda snuggled up to him and draped one leg over his. "You can do that again later."

"Are you trying to give me a heart attack? I'm not as fit as I used to be."

"Neither am I," she said. She ran her hand over his tummy. "Maybe we could join a gym and make it something we do together on a regular basis. A ten-minute workout followed by an hour in the sauna and hot-tub."

"Sounds good, but I think I'd need more than a ten-minute workout to get fit."

She stretched up and kissed his neck. "We can have a lot more horizontal workouts like this one."

"I'd like that." George smiled. "Work won't always be this busy, I promise."

She nodded, and they lay and dozed in a comfortable silence for almost an hour. George thought back to how wet Brenda had been when he'd first entered her, and his absurd thought about it being Oscar's cum. Could the inventory problem be down to something similar? What if one person didn't add the data because they thought it was already there? Alternatively, what if both people added the same data twice? The problem figures had occurred during holiday periods, summer, Christmas and Easter.

Before he could think about this further, Brenda woke from her slumber and they began fondling each other again. While she sucked him to hardness, he pleased her with her vibrator. George made her come using the sex toy, then he went back inside her. Brenda didn't manage to come again, but he did.

They eventually got out of bed in the early afternoon, showered together then walked to a local pub. It had been years since the two of them had chatted and laughed about things as they ate and drank. After leaving the pub, they walked home hand-in-hand, watched TV and went to bed, where they made love again. This time there was far less urgency than their earlier trysts, though the passion was still there.

* * * *

George woke at 6.30, slipped quietly out of bed and went down to the kitchen. While he was boiling the kettle, he sensed someone behind him. He knew it wasn't Brenda. When he turned around, Oscar was leaning against the door jamb.

George smiled. "Thank you. You've saved me again."

"That's what friends are for." Oscar looked pretty pleased with himself.

"I hope you're not expecting a hug."

"Not from you, you fat bastard."

George laughed out loud. "We're going to join a gym."

"So I heard."

When the kettle had boiled, George poured two mugs of tea. “Will I see you at the office?”

Oscar shook his head. “You don’t need me there now everything’s sorted. Besides, there’s no point if you’re not going to be actually shagging either Claire or Tina.”

George nodded. “I hope I don’t need you again.”

“You might.”

“You’ll probably be completely bald by then.”

Oscar snorted and walked back into the living room. George picked up the mugs and left the kitchen. The living room was empty.

Brenda smiled as she sat up and took the tea from him. George sat on the bed and they chatted as they drank.

She placed her hand on his arm. “Do you want me to phone in and take the day off? I’m sure they’ll understand if I tell them you’re off work with stress.”

He shook his head. “No, I’ll go into work today.”

“Why not leave it and go back after the weekend?”

“I need to get a couple of things out of the way.” He smiled at her. “I’m fine, I promise.”

“Okay, if you’re sure.”

He went downstairs for a bowl of muesli while Brenda showered, then he shaved and showered, dressed in a clean suit and got in his car. The journey was a little dull without Oscar’s running commentary on everything he did wrong. There was no talking to himself as he walked across the car park, and once in his office he fired up his computer and opened up all the files on both his and Barry’s team.

He smiled when he read the reply from the data-entry leader. He quickly typed up brief comments in all the necessary boxes on the HR assessment forms for his own team but left those of Barry’s team blank, then printed all six sheets out.

By ten o’clock he felt like he had everything he needed. He sent Claire an email to say he was in the office and ready to chat about work issues. Two minutes later, his phone rang. It was Claire.

“What are you doing in the office?” she asked.

“What you pay me for. I’m doing my job.”

“Are you okay?”

“I’m fine. But thank you for your concern. Will you have time today for a quick meet-up to sort these things out?”

“Yep. Now’s fine if you want to come up.”

“Great, I’ll see you in a minute.” He picked up the sheets from the printer, left his office and walked up the stairs. Tracy told him to go straight in.

Claire smiled from behind her desk, got up and came and gave him a hug. She held his gaze for a second, then nodded towards the table in the corner. When they were both seated, she raised her eyebrows. “So, tell me your news then I’ll tell you mine.”

He wasn’t sure what that meant but didn’t let it put him off. “Okay, first things first. The figure discrepancy has been sorted. It’s a simple case of two people putting the data in. When the regular person takes a holiday, she puts the data in when she gets back because the person covering for her wasn’t supposed to. But for some reason that person decided they’d put the data in anyway, so it ends up going in twice.”

Claire frowned. “But wouldn’t the spreadsheet show the data’s already there?”

He shook his head. “Not in the way the data is added in our system. You know how the saying goes, the optimist sees the glass as half full, the pessimist sees it as half empty, but Excel sees it as the first of February.”

Claire laughed. “I knew you’d sort it out. Well done. Right, the appraisals?”

He handed over the completed forms from his own team. “They’ve all done well, but Sarah’s had an exceptional year. They all deserve something, but she deserves the most.”

Claire was watching his face closely. “And Barry’s team?”

He placed the sheets on her desk. “I haven’t written anything down, but...”

She smiled. “Be honest.”

“Dan’s had a good year. I’ve actually got him doing some of the stuff Barry usually does. He’ll be able to carry out a lot of those tasks until Barry returns.”

Claire nodded, looking pleased. “The others?”

“John’s done okay. I think it’s fair to say he hasn’t pushed himself.”

“And Callum?”

“He’s a fucking waste of carbon.”

Claire snorted. “I’m glad you didn’t write that on the HR form.”

“Sorry, but he needs a boot up his arse.”

“That’s pretty well what Barry said about his team, though he wasn’t quite as eloquent as you were.” She smiled and nodded. “Right, and now for my news. I’d assumed you’d take some time off—”

“I’m fine. Really.”

She nodded. “Good. I was going to invite you to lunch one day next week.”

“Would you have worn the red shoes?”

She laughed and shook her head. “I hardly think fuck-me shoes would impress you, considering you’ve had me practically naked, sprawled out on an office chair.”

George smiled. “Yeah, great memories.”

She gave a mock frown. “Stop it.”

“I should have fucked you.”

She smiled at him. “Yes, you should have. But I knew you were engaged at the time, and I always respected you for not going further. And now you’re happily married, which might not have been the case had you not shown restraint.”

George nodded.

Claire smiled, then continued. “When I spoke to the directors the other day, they acknowledged that you and Barry had been put under too much pressure.”

“It can be tough performing three times a day with a woman like Tina.”

“Yes, I imagine it is.” She turned serious. “There’s a good chance that Barry won’t be coming back to work here.”

“Is his son—?”

“It’s nothing to do with his smack-addled teenager. It’s because he’s not been doing his fucking job.”

George felt a tightening in his stomach. Was he expected to do two people’s jobs permanently? Yesterday he’d promised Brenda things would get better.

“So what I suggested was to promote two people into the roles you and Barry are currently filling, and introduce a new layer of management to oversee them.”

George’s mind tried to play catch up. “So you’re not asking me to do Barry’s job as well as my own?”

“No. I’m suggesting we promote Sarah to do your job, and Dan to do Barry’s. I want you to fill the new role, picking up a few of the senior tasks you and Barry have done. I’d like you to make sure those two can do what they need to do without getting overwhelmed. You may also be able to take on a few things that I currently do.”

“Wow.”

“It’ll mean you get a shiny new office on this floor. You’ll also get a considerable pay rise, a car allowance and access to the share option scheme. But most importantly, you won’t need to put in as many extra hours to keep your head above water.”

“Will I get to wear fuck-me shoes?”

She laughed. “*I’m* the only one allowed to wear those, though I noticed Tracy has some cute little ankle boots on today. I’ll have to reprimand her.”

“I don’t know what to say.”

“Say ‘yes Claire, thank you Claire, I accept and will be eternally grateful.’”

George gave a grateful smile.

“Go and tell Sarah, then go home and have a nice weekend. Take Brenda out to dinner and let her plan what to spend your new salary on.”

George stood up and smiled. “Thanks, Claire.”

“You’ve earned it. Thanks for doing your job well *and* for helping out when the shit hit the fan.”

George left and smiled at Tracy, wishing he could see her footwear, then went back down to his own office. He phoned Brenda immediately.

When she answered her mobile, she sounded concerned. “Hi. Is everything okay?”

“Yeah, fine. Actually, it’s better than fine. I phoned to ask where you wanted me to take you for dinner tonight?”

“Oh? You mean out, like to a pub?”

“Choose any restaurant and I’ll see if I can get us a table.”

“George, are you sure you’re alright?”

“Yes, I’m fine. I have some news that I was going to save until later—but since you’re convinced I’m cracking up I’ll tell you over the phone. I’ve been promoted. It’ll mean less work at home, and more money.”

“Really?”

“Yep.”

“Wow.”

“That’s what I said.”

“I don’t know what to say.”

“Tell me the name of a restaurant, and then spend the afternoon thinking about what you’re going to wear tonight.”

“What do you want me to wear?”

“Something sexy, and fuck-me shoes.”

She purred down the phone, making his balls tingle. “Okay. I’ll go online and look at some restaurants. Chances are we may need to try a few to get a table at such short notice, so why don’t I book it?”

“Okay. And there’s something else you should start to look at online.”

“What?”

“Bigger houses. Find us one with a garden and space for parking.”

“Are you serious?”

“Yep.”

“God, we might have to spend the entire weekend in bed.”

“Ask Vicky to pinch me some of the major’s blue pills.”

Brenda giggled. “I’ll see you later.”

“Bye, love.” George ended the call.

The office felt strangely empty without Oscar. He left, walked down the corridor and into the large office his team shared. Sarah was working at her desk.

George smiled at her. “Hiya. Have you got a minute?”

THE END



[Delores Swallows](#)

United Kingdom (2022)

About the Author



Delores Swallows has many dirty thoughts, and during his free time he writes them down in the form of stories. Born and bred in the northwest of England, he has a commoner's accent and a bit of a crush on his future queen (Kate, not Camilla!).

His stories often feature petite brunettes, high-heeled shoes and voyeurism. He claims he didn't realise these were obsessions until someone pointed out how often they appear in his work.

Find out more about Delores on his [web site](#), chat on [Twitter](#), or follow his new stories on [Amazon](#). And don't forget to sign up to his [mailing list](#) for a **free story**.

Delores Swallows is proud to be a member of #ACHE
(Authors of Cuckolding/Hotwife Erotica)



Check out the other authors in the group for more sexy reads.



Don't forget your dirty story exclusively available to members of [Delores' mailing list](#).

Also by Delores Swallows



Dream Witch

Joe closed his eyes and tried to visualise his wife's face. "Are you imagining it's me?"

"Of course not. Do you fantasise about me when you have a wank?"

Her words made his eyes snap open. "I... Yeah, of course."

"Liar." She gave another laugh. "Well, I'm not thinking about you now."

"Who are you thinking about?"

"Some nameless guy who just picked me up in a bar." She gave a quiet grunt. "I was out with a friend, and some guy came over to tell me how good he'd make me feel if I let him take me to the alley out back."

Joe smiled. "I can't see a chat-up line like that working on you."

"Well, it worked tonight, because I let him."

His throat was closing in, making it hard to talk. "And what happened when you got there?"

"He pushed me to my knees, opened his trousers and told me to suck his cock."

Frowning, Joe wondered what had gotten into her. He knew that in the real world, she'd never have been picked up like this. Furthermore, any man who spoke to her in that way would have had his penis bitten off.

"What did you do?"

"I sucked his cock."

"Did he like it?"

“Oh yeah.”

“And did he come?”

“No. As soon as he was fully hard he pulled me up and bent me over a dustbin.”

“Ooh, sexy.”

Chrissie laughed. “It’s a clean dustbin, but it’s a dirty fantasy.”

“Oh?”

“Hmm, because as soon as I was bent over the bin, he lifted my skirt, pulled my thong to one side, and slid his big hard cock inside me.”

Her breathing had become heavy. From the buzzing sounds, he could tell she was pumping her toy faster. “Did he make you come like that?”

“He will. I’m still bent over the bin, and he’s still fucking me.”

“What about your friend?”

“She knows what I’m up to.”

This was so unlike Chrissie, but Joe didn’t care. “She’ll think you’re easy.”

“I don’t care. She’s inside sipping white wine spritzers, I’m outside getting reamed by a huge cock. I know which of us is having the better night.”

Joe’s cock was getting harder by the second. He pictured what Chrissie was describing, then a thought occurred. “You don’t usually come when you’re fucked from behind.”

“Yeah, but I’m not usually fucked from behind by someone with a cock this big.”

“Bitch.”

She laughed.

“Maybe he’ll reach around and rub your clit while he’s fucking you.”

Chrissie gave a quiet moan. “Maybe he will.”

Joe lowered his voice to a whisper. “Are you rubbing your clit now?”

“Yeah.”

“Are you going to come?”

“Mm hmm.”

“Will he?”

“Oh yeah, he’ll come with me.”

“At the same time?”

“Mmm.”

“Is he wearing a condom?”

“It’s a fantasy, Joe. Do you wear a condom when you fuck your dream dates?”

The inclusion of the word ‘dream’ ripped him out of the moment. Could Chrissie know he’d been having dreams about their neighbour?

“Oh, I’m going to come.”

Joe closed his eyes and tried to recapture the image of his wife bent over in an alley as some unknown man took her from behind. “I’m glad he’s going to make you come.”

“Hmm. Are you jacking off?”

“No.” This wasn’t exactly true. He was stroking his erection but with no intention of taking himself all the way.

“Why not?”

“Because when I come, I want to be inside you.”

Her breathing got louder in the earpiece. “Joe, I’m close.”

“Is he?”

“Yeah. He’s fucking me hard and calling me dirty names.”

“What sort of names?”

“Slut. Whore. Cum-bucket.”

“You’re none of those things.”

“I am tonight. I’m his slut, his whore, and soon I’ll be his cum-bucket.”

Chrissie never said things like this. Joe was about to ask if she usually fantasised about these sorts of liaisons when her moans made it obvious she was coming. He closed his eyes and listened, his cock now aching. He’d probably have to make himself come after this.

Chrissie eventually quietened down, then he heard the buzzing stop abruptly, without getting louder. Either she’d turned it off before withdrawing it, or she’d turned it off but left it inside. He hoped it was the latter.

“How was it for you?” he asked.

She gave a quiet, sated sigh. “It was very nice, thanks for asking.”

“I wish I was there with you.”

“Hmm. Maybe my man would bend you over the bin and give you the same.”

Joe laughed. “Thanks, but no thanks.”

“Did you come?” She sounded like she was smiling.

“No, but now I’m really horny.”

“Good. It’s fine if you want to make yourself come. I can guarantee I’ll be able to make you do it again tomorrow night.”

“Promise?”

“Oh yeah.” She sighed, and he heard her moving on the bed. “Right, I need to charge my phone and put my nightwear back on.”

“Okay, I’ll see you tomorrow.”

“Good luck with the presentation.”

“Thanks. Night, love.” Joe ended the call, closed his eyes and continued to stroke his cock.

Though still a little shocked, he replayed what she’d described. In his mind’s eye, he was watching Chrissie in the alley with the well-hung stranger through a gap in the curtains of the pub window. Her expression was a mixture of pain and pleasure as the guy plunged into her over and over again.

A head pushed against his own, peering through the curtains with him. “That’s so fucking hot,” a woman’s voice said.

Joe turned, surprised to not only see Ava sitting next to him, but also to hear her thoughts on his wife being fucked by a stranger. “What’s hot?”

She smiled at him. “Chrissie taking another man, and you jerking off watching her do it.”



When Ava moves in next door, neither Joe nor Chrissie expect the gorgeous brunette to have such an impact on their relationship. Ava's friendly and considerate. A perfect neighbour.

Then the dreams start.

Though not usually one who remembers his dreams, Joe begins to see Ava on a nightly basis. As her visits become more and more lascivious, he soon realises that Chrissie's also experiencing some serious nocturnal stimulation.

Just as they're reaping the benefits of their heightened libidos, Joe's dreams take on a disconcerting edge. He sees Chrissie with other men. If that wasn't unsettling enough, it seems she's having dreams that are uncannily similar to his own.

Chrissie dismisses his allegations that their neighbour's behind it all until she goes to Ava's for dinner while Joe's away on a work trip. His dream that night is the most realistic yet. What's more, what he's watching is no longer quite as disconcerting as he'd first thought...

[Dream Witch](#) is available from Amazon



Rediscovering Stephanie

I head off to the bar. While I'm waiting in the queue, I watch Steph and Robert talk. She's more animated than usual, flirting with him. I reason that her getting chatted up might improve the chances of her visiting my bed tonight but then feel a little guilty at the thought of benefitting from Robert's groundwork.

When I get back to the table, their conversation suddenly stops, Steph sucking her drink through the straw while holding eye contact with him. Then she looks at me and smiles.

As the piano guy starts his second set, Steph immediately gets up and holds out her hand to Robert. He laughs, shrugs at me and takes her to dance. It's good to see her enjoying herself. There's a sparkle in her eyes that hasn't been there for a long time, and I can hear her laughter above the sound of the music. My view of them is obscured by other dancers. By the time they come back in sight, Robert has the flower from her hair between his teeth and Steph is smiling up at him. They're dancing close, his hands resting on her hips while hers grip his upper arms. The music stops and they come back, both of them breathing hard.

Robert drops the flower on the table and downs what's left of his cocktail. "My round, I think."

Steph smiles. "Another Wallbanger, please."

I nod for the same, and he walks off to the bar.

I lean close. "I'm surprised you didn't ask him for a Sex on the Beach."

She laughs. "No, the sand gets everywhere. Maybe a Slow Comfortable Screw Against The Wall would be okay, though."

Her comment stuns me, and she giggles at my expression. She takes the straw between her lips and sucks while holding my gaze. I haven't seen her this playful in years. Robert returns with three drinks, and we talk some

more. He's not wearing a wedding ring and the subject of his home life hasn't been brought up. The pair of them are sharing little looks and laughing. His gaze is dropping even more often to the tanned valley between her breasts. Every time she crosses her legs or leans forward, Robert's eyes follow her movements. He continually glances down at the only exposed skin below her waist, which is the ankle and foot of her hanging leg. For some reason, this ogling doesn't annoy me the way it usually would do. I realise I like that the guy fancies my wife, and it's obvious that Steph's enjoying his attention as well.

A random thought sideswipes me: What would happen if I weren't here?

If Steph had been on her own when she met Robert, how far would she go? I've never considered having an affair and am confident Steph hasn't cheated on me, either. But the chemistry between the two of them is undeniable. The thought of Steph being here alone and allowing herself to be seduced gives me mixed emotions. I suck on my drink as images of them dancing flit through my mind.

A modified question springs to mind: what would she do if I gave her the chance to sleep with Robert? Would she take me up on the offer? Could I cope with it if she did?

A gnawing in my gut makes me feel like it'd be selfish to deny her the chance. It's been a long time—probably too long—since she's laughed and had fun like this. It's been years since I've seen that look on her face. Would our marriage really suffer if she were to enjoy one night with a guy who's obviously enamoured with her?

I finish my drink first and stand up. "What's the order?" I wonder if Steph will repeat her Slow Comfortable Screw request, but instead she keeps the straw between her lips and points at her glass. Robert nods for the same, and I leave them together again.

From the bar, I watch them laugh and chat. Their heads move closer together and I hold my breath, half-expecting them to kiss. Instead, Steph bursts out laughing and falls back against her chair. Robert's whispering was probably a dirty joke.

When the barmaid gets to me, I order six drinks. Once they're fixed, I carry them back to the table on a tray.

Steph's eyes go wide. "Have you developed a drinking problem?"

“I thought maybe we could take them back to the chalet.”

I see Robert look questioningly in Steph’s direction, but her eyes are boring into mine.

“It’s just a thought. If you’d rather stay here, that’s fine.”

Holding my gaze, she slowly stands, then grabs two of the glasses. “It’s a great idea.” Smiling at Robert, she adds, “unless it’s too late for our early riser?”

He shakes his head. “Like you said, I can always sleep on the boat.”

We all laugh and head off down the flower-lined path, carrying two glasses each. My stomach’s in knots, and I don’t really know what my preferred outcome would be. Maybe there’ll be more laughing and flirting, then Robert will head back to his own room while Steph and I share a bed. Or maybe there’ll be more flirting, then more-than-flirting...



When Ian takes Stephanie away for a week in the sun, he hopes she'll finally be able to relax after working long hours at the doctors' surgery

during the pandemic.

Last time they'd visited these islands, his wife was the belle of the pool. Twenty years on, she'll barely take her sarong off. It takes several days of gentle walks, sangria and cocktails for both the stress and the self-consciousness to drain away.

When their holiday's nearly up, they meet Robert, a fellow Brit enjoying a fishing holiday. As Ian watches Steph chat to him, he notices her acting in a way he hasn't seen in years—she's laughing, dancing and even flirting.

Pleased to see the old Steph emerge, Ian wonders what would have happened if she'd met Robert while alone. Would she have allowed herself to be seduced?

Then another thought sideswipes him: What would she do if he gave her the go-ahead to have a little fun, even though he was there?

They're in a tropical paradise with a man they'll never meet again. Could their marriage survive if she slept with Robert?

Could Ian live with himself if he denied her the opportunity?

[Rediscovering Stephanie](#) is available from Amazon

